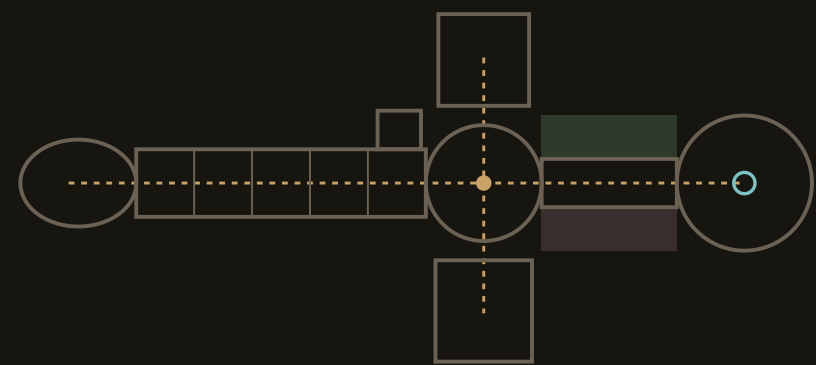
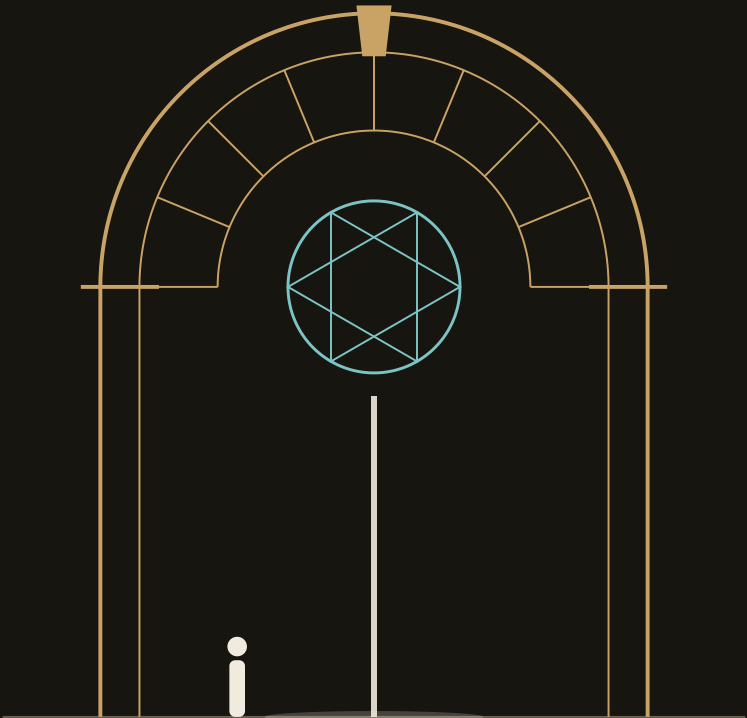


A GUIDE TO THE MUSEUM · APPLE VISION PRO

Musée Vision

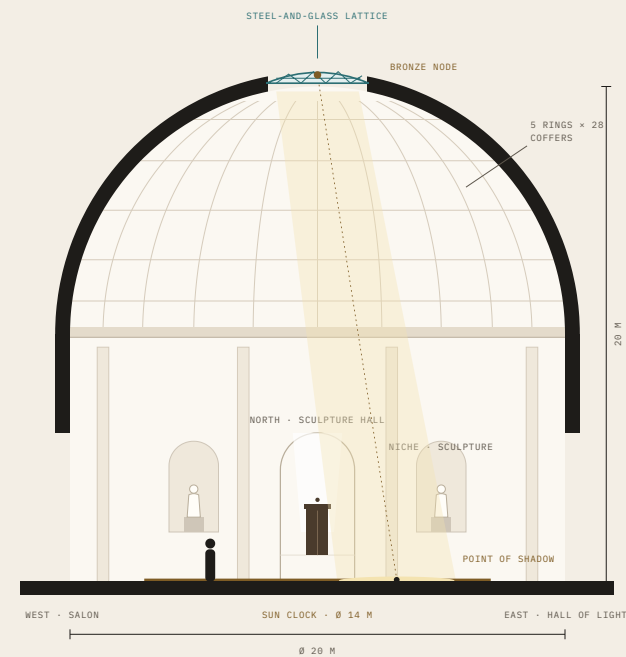
Classical bones. Modern light. Future glass.

A walk through every room of the master canvas, in the order you meet them: from the sun clock under the Rotunda’s dome, through painting, sculpture and a Chinese garden, east through glass and gardens to the stars.



One building, three eras

A museum you step into. Each room keeps its classical proportions while taking one more step, eastward, toward modern light and future glass.

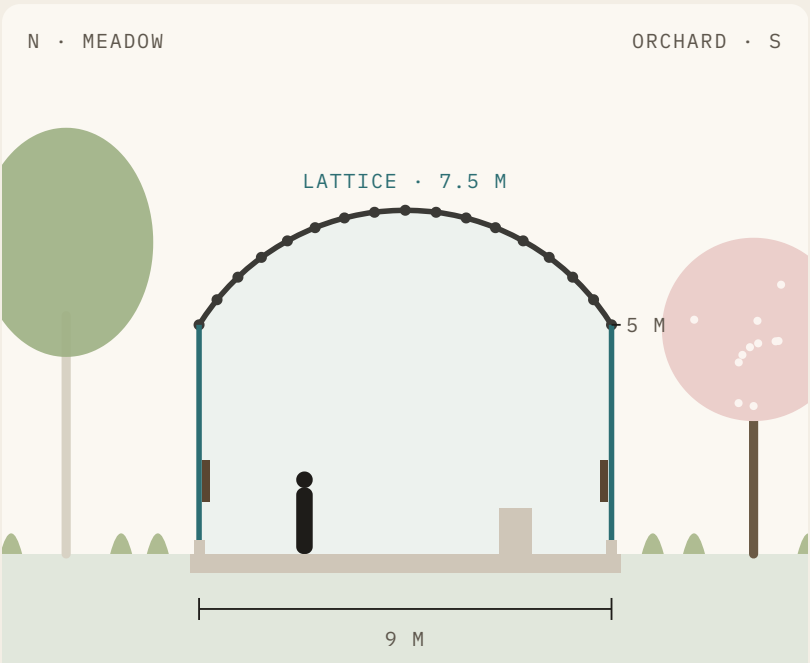


I · CLASSICAL

The bones

Proportion, symmetry and procession. Marble floors, coffered vaults, pilasters, and doorways that line up into one long view.

THE ROTUNDA · SALON IMPRESSION · SCULPTURE HALL · CHINESE WING

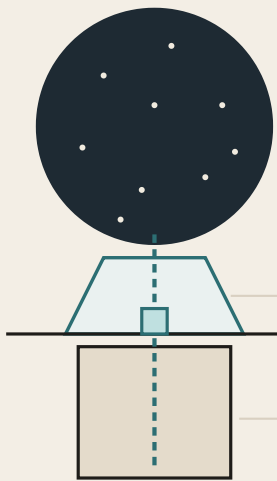


II · MODERN · ALIVE

The light

Restraint around the art, life around the room. Shadow gaps instead of mouldings, walls of glass, and gardens growing right up to them.

THE HALL OF LIGHT



III · FUTURE

The glass

What only a virtual building can do. Parametric lattices, placards that float, thresholds that glow, and rooms at impossible scale.

ÉLAN: THE ATRIUM, THE SQUARE, THE SPHERE

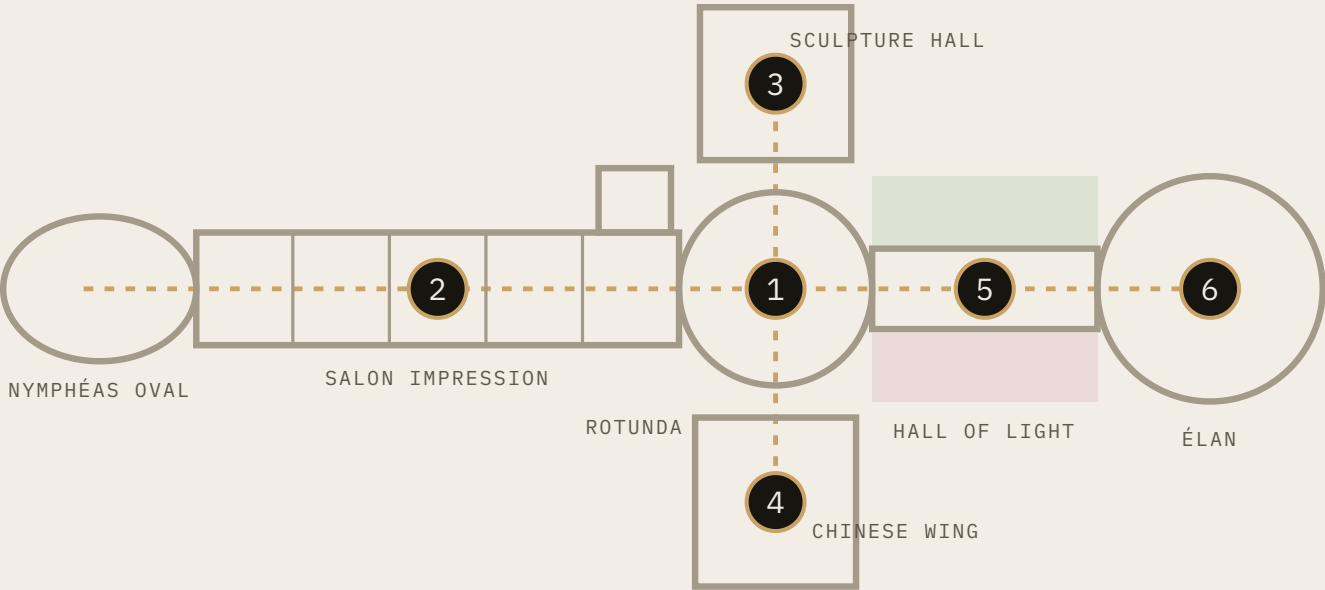


Six chapters, one walk

Every visit starts on the sun clock. The three classical wings open off the Rotunda; the way on runs east, through glass, into the future.

I	START	
	The Rotunda	6
	Where every visit begins: a sun clock under a steel-and-glass eye	
2	WEST	
	Salon Impression	9
	Five bays, the Manet cabinet, the Nymphéas Oval, and the Reserve below	
3	NORTH	
	Sculpture Hall	22
	One top-lit court, ten works, The Gates of Hell on the axis	
4	SOUTH	
	The Chinese Wing	25
	The Garden of the Four Seasons, through a moon gate	
5	EAST	
	Hall of Light	29
	Thirty metres of glass between two gardens	
6	ONWARD	
	Élan	32
	The Atrium, the Square below and the Sphere above	

Before you begin: the idea p. 2 · the plan p. 4 · entering on Vision Pro p. 5



N

0 10 20 M

THE POND LIFTS ↓
STAIR TO THE RESERVE · LEVEL -1

NYMPHÉAS OVAL

SALON IMPRESSION
WEST · FIVE BAYS · 84 M

THE ROTUNDA
YOU BEGIN HERE

MANET CABINET

SCULPTURE HALL
NORTH DOOR · TOP-LIT COURT

NORTH GARDEN

HALL OF LIGHT
EAST · GLASS · PHOTOGRAPHS

SOUTH GARDEN

SECTION II · ÉLAN
THE ATRIUM · GLASS ELEVATOR
SPHERE ABOVE · SQUARE BELOW

CHINESE WING
SOUTH DOOR · MOON GATE

LEVEL 2 · THE SPHERE, SAME SCALE

LEVEL -1 · THE RESERVE

SAME SCALE

BENEATH THE SALON

POND

..... The route from the Rotunda

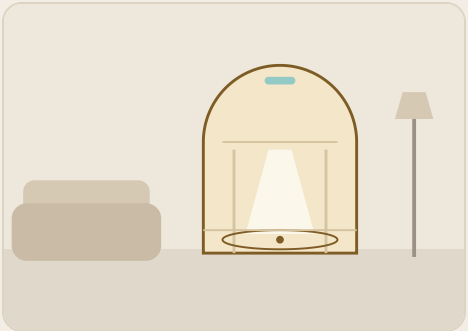
..... Below ground: the Reserve and Élan's square floor

From your living room to the Rotunda

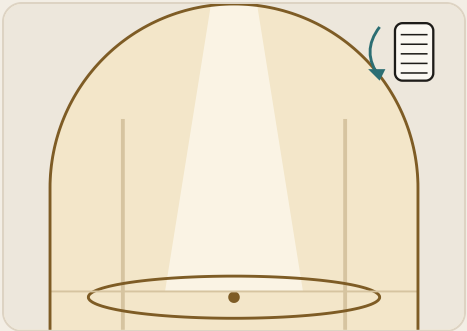
The museum never drops you in cold. It arrives as a doorway in your own room, and you decide how far to step in. Once inside, you stand still and the building comes to you.



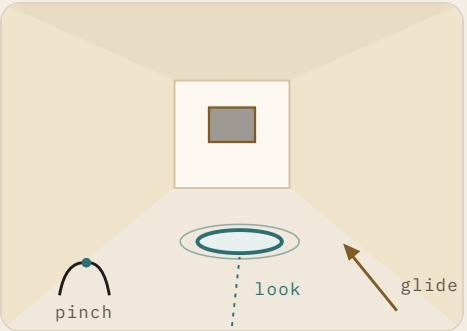
STEP 1
Arrive
A small window floats in your own room. Tap Enter.



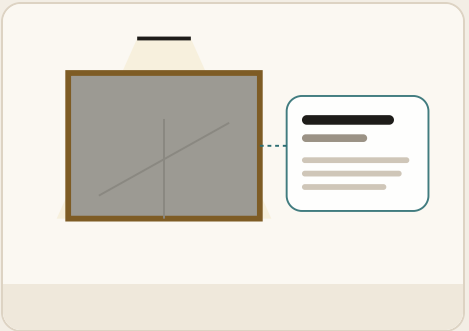
STEP 2
A doorway opens
The Rotunda appears as an arched portal in your wall, sunlight and all.



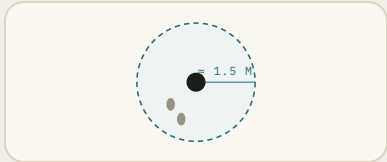
STEP 3
Turn the Digital Crown
The museum grows around you until your room is gone. Turn back to return at any time.



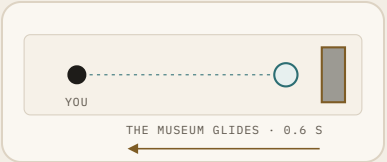
STEP 4
Look, pinch, glide
Look at a glowing viewing stone and pinch. The museum glides to you; you never move.



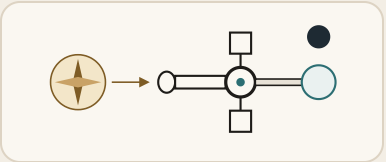
STEP 5
Meet the painting
Pinch a painting to open its glass placard. Pinch again to hear its story.



WALK
A metre and a half of real floor around you; step further and the museum fades to show your room.



GLIDE
Viewing stones sit where a curator would want you to stand. Pinch one and you arrive facing the art.



JUMP
Look down: a bronze compass at your feet opens the map. Go to any room, or back to the Rotunda.

01
Nothing moves unless you pinch.

02
You always arrive facing something worth seeing.

03
Horizons stay level: no turning, no bobbing.

04
Light leads. The next place to go is the brightest thing in view.

A wide-angle photograph of the interior of a large, circular rotunda. The ceiling is a massive dome with a grid of square coffers. At the very top is a circular skylight with a steel-and-glass structure. The walls are made of light-colored stone or marble, featuring several arched doorways and niches. The floor is polished and reflects the light. In the center of the floor is a large, circular bronze sun clock with Roman numerals and a central sunburst. A person in a dark coat stands near the center, looking towards a bright doorway at the far end of the rotunda. The overall atmosphere is bright and grand.

CHAPTER 1 · WHERE EVERY VISIT BEGINS

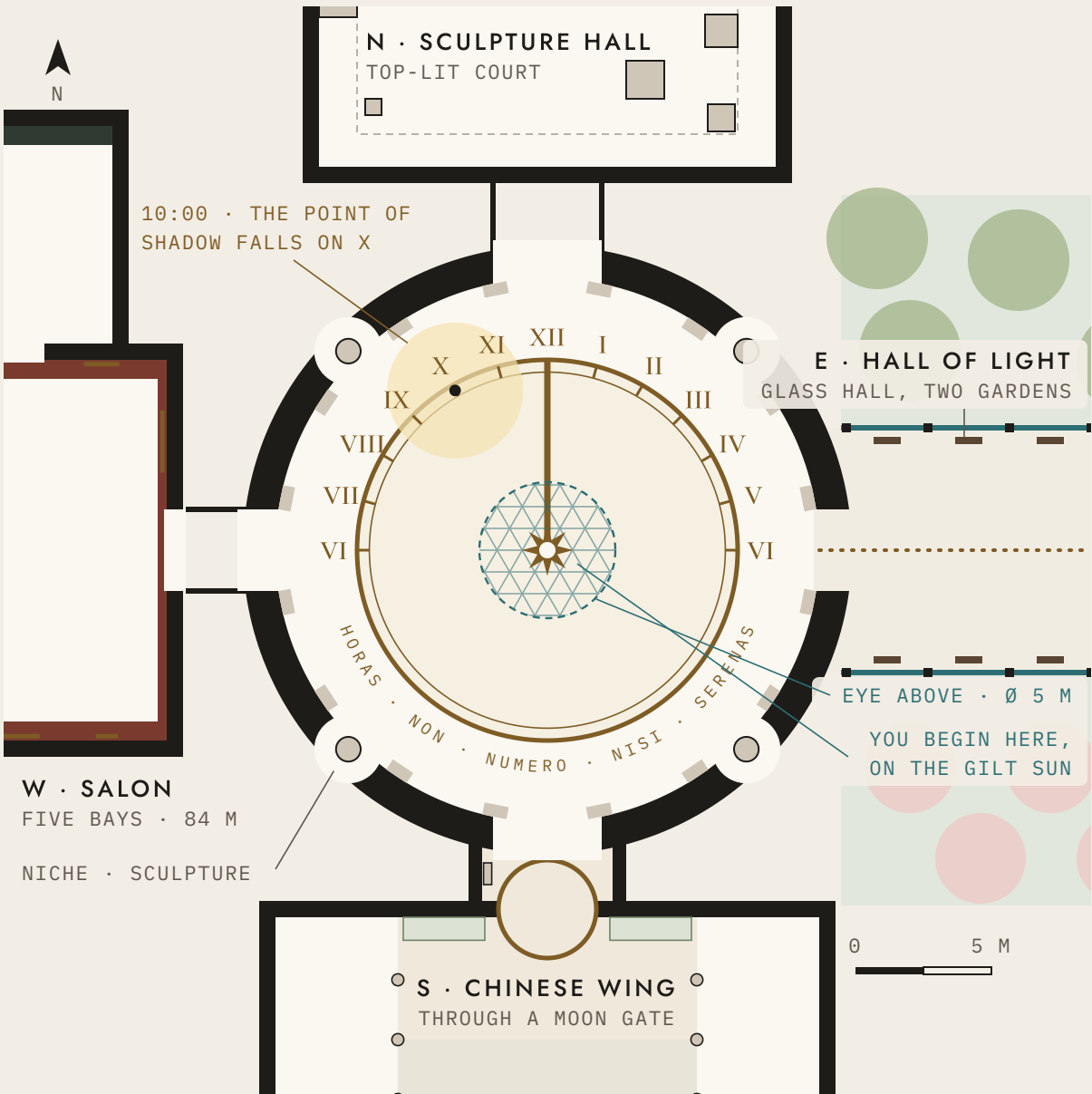
The Rotunda

You arrive on the gilt sun at the centre of a bronze sun clock, under a coffered dome 20 m across with a steel-and-glass eye. Four doors lead out.

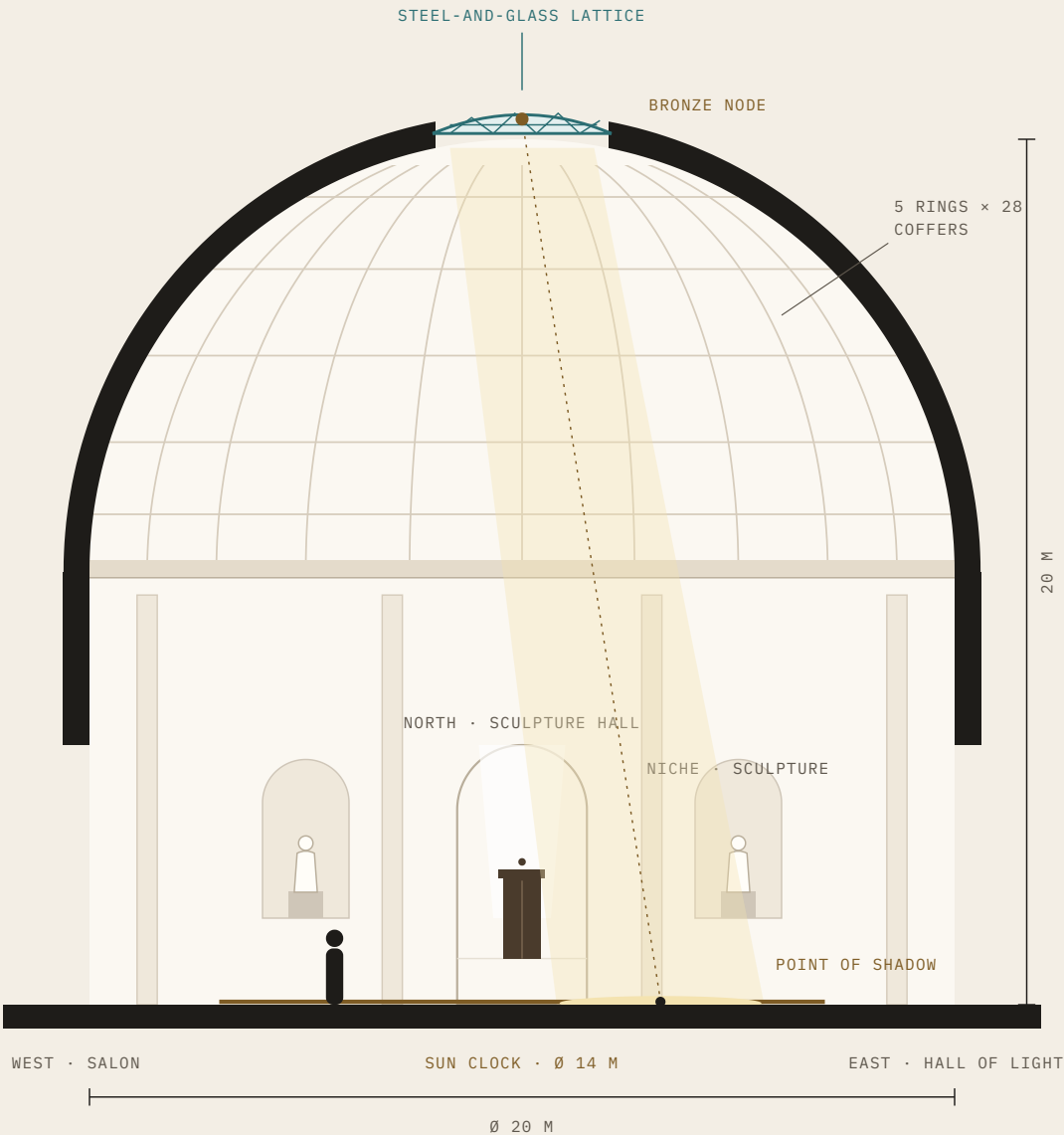
The sun clock and four doors

A coffered dome 20 m across, just under half the Pantheon. A bronze node in the lattice casts a point of shadow that walks the numerals from VI to VI.

PLAN • NORTH UP



SECTION • LOOKING NORTH



Four doors, seen from the sun

You always start here, and you always come back here. Each door frames its own room before you step through.

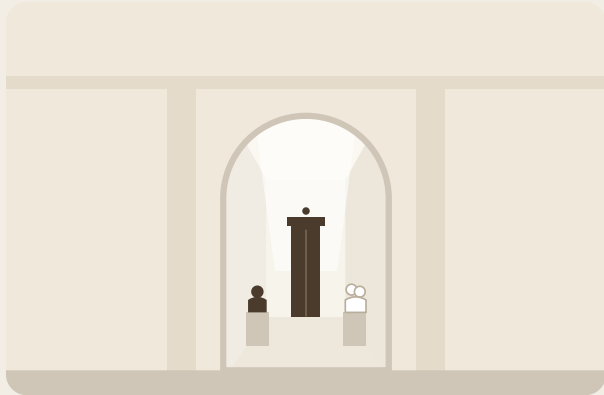


WEST

Salon Impression

Bay 1 opens off the door: Impression, Sunrise on its glass stele.

CHAPTER 2 • PAGE 9



NORTH

Sculpture Hall

A top-lit court. The Gates of Hell close the view from the sun.

CHAPTER 3 • PAGE 22

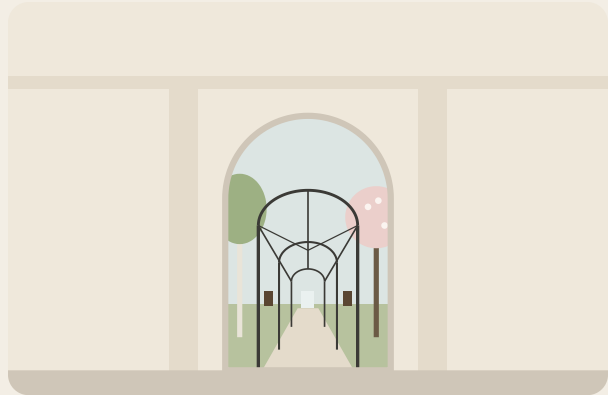


SOUTH

Chinese Wing

Past the solar-term stele, a moon gate frames the garden and the sky.

CHAPTER 4 • PAGE 25



EAST • ONWARD

Hall of Light

The way on: a glass hall between two gardens, hung with the first photographs.

CHAPTER 5 • PAGE 29

The floor keeps the hour

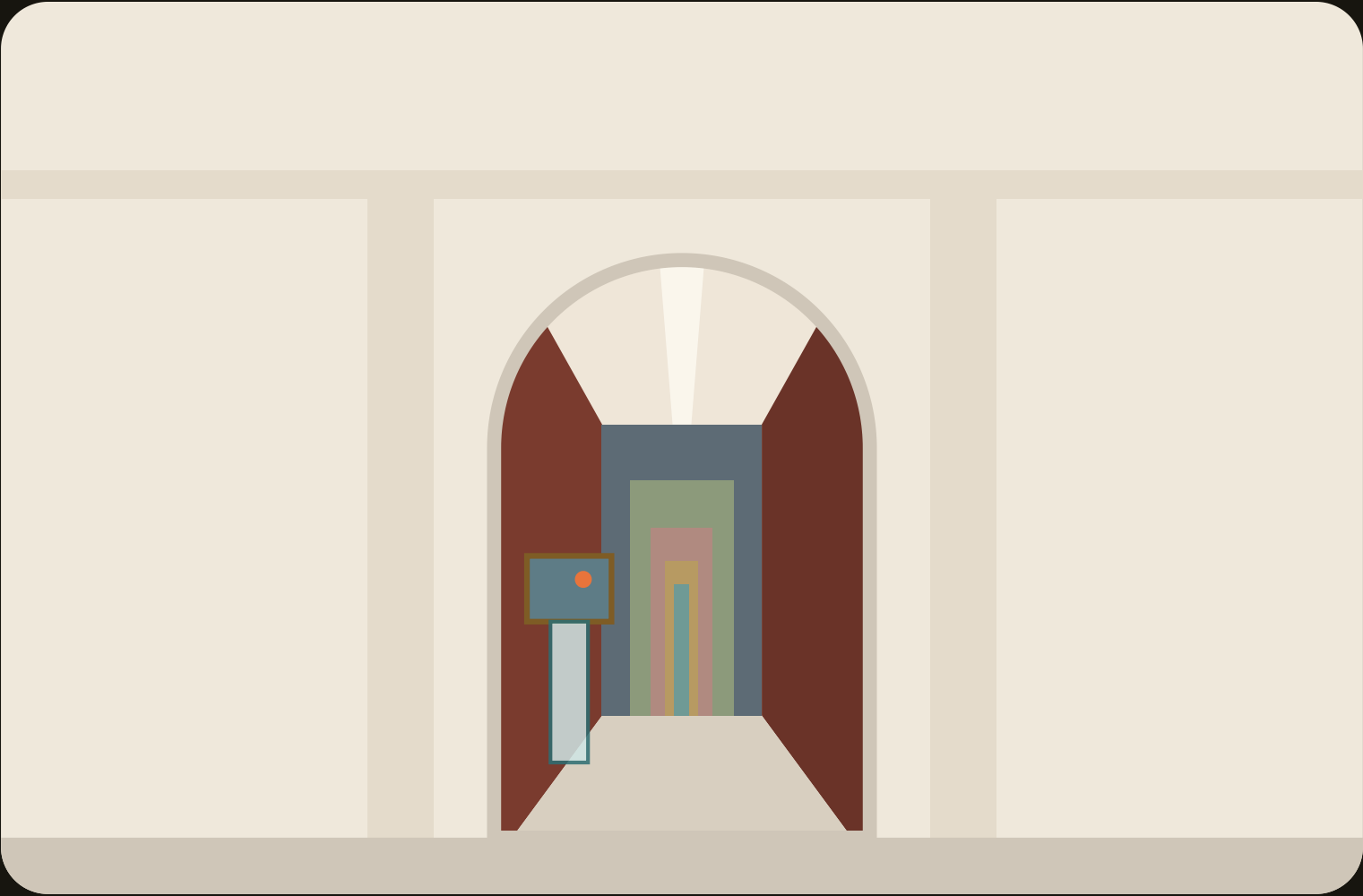
A 14 m bronze sundial in the tradition of Rome’s meridian lines. Motto: HORAS NON NUMERO NISI SERENAS.

The one touch of future

The sun keeps your local time on an even path, 15° an hour in every season, so the point always lands on the hour.

A lattice in the eye

A regular steel-and-glass grid in the spirit of the British Museum’s Great Court. On a rainy day you hear the rain on the glass.



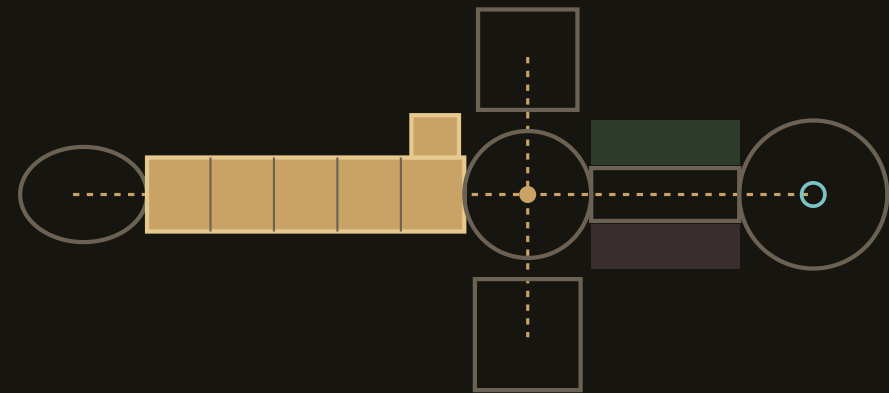
From the sun, turn west. Through the door, *Impression, Sunrise* waits on its glass stele.

Salon Impression

An 84-metre enfilade of five skylit bays, one chapter of Impressionism each, with its own wall colour. A side cabinet for Manet, and at the far end an oval of Monet's *Water Lilies* around a pond of living lilies.

84 m	7	37	13
END TO END	SPACES	WORKS	IN THE RESERVE

WHERE YOU ARE



SALON IMPRESSION • ARRIVAL

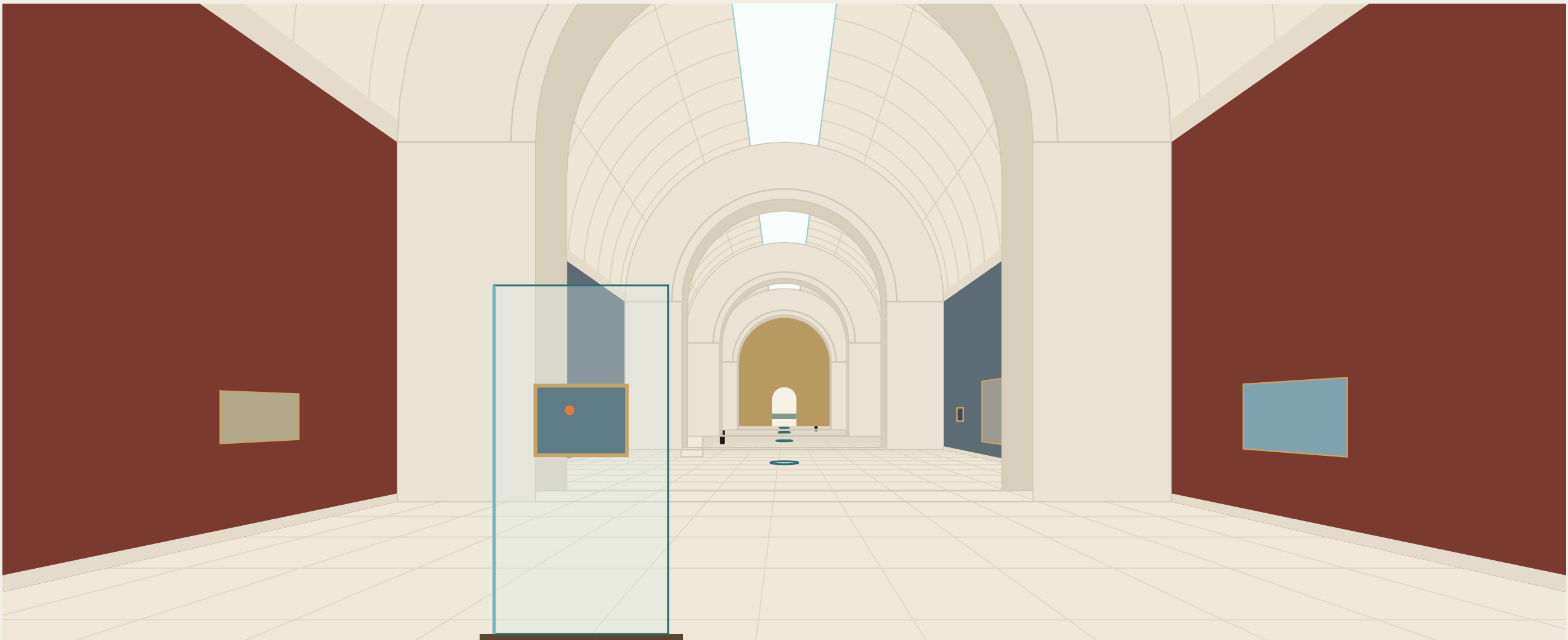
Arrival: Impression, Sunrise

Monet's painting floats on its glass stele three metres ahead, just off the axis. Beside it, five arches frame five wall colours, and at the far end the Oval's door glows.



Classical bones throughout: a coffered barrel vault on transverse arches, a cornice, fabric walls. The modern touches are in the details: the shadow gap, a light-grid skylight, a glass stele.

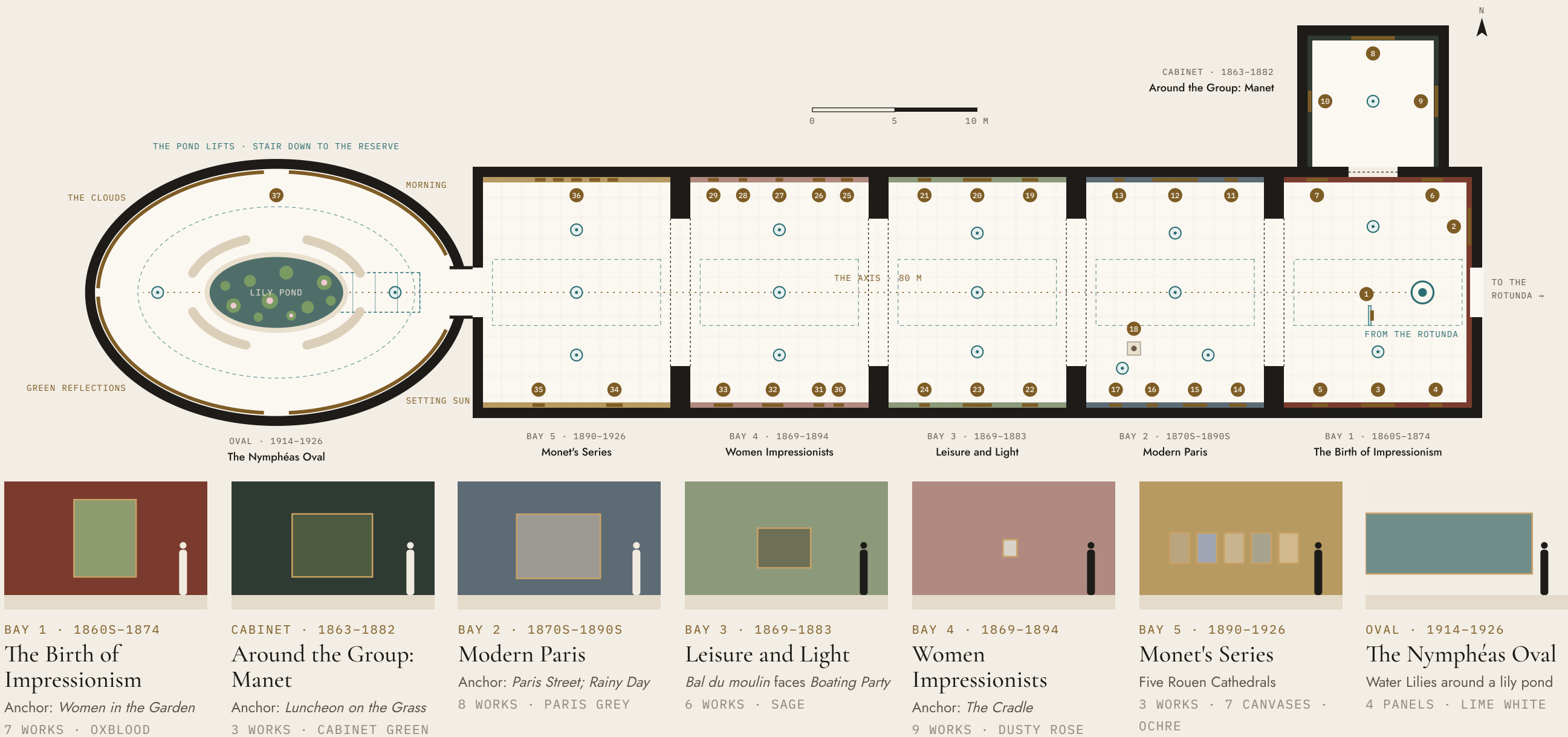
Looking west down the axis



Impression, Sunrise floats on its glass stele three metres ahead, just off the axis. Five arches frame five wall colours; the Oval's door glows at the far end.

Five bays, a cabinet, an oval

You walk west, forward in time: each bay is one chapter of the story in its own wall colour.
Numbers mark every work at its true width; the rings are viewing stones.



Bay 1 and the Manet cabinet

Every wall at one scale, every work at its true size, with a 1.75 m visitor for comparison. The hanging line is 1.55 m to the centre.

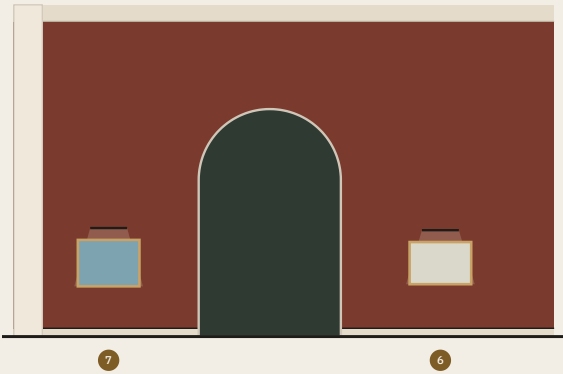
BAY 1 • 1860s–1874

The Birth of Impressionism

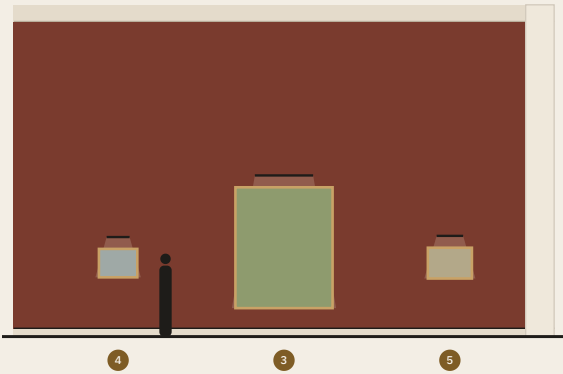
OXBLOOD • #7A3B2E

- 1
- Impression, Sunrise* • Monet, 1872 • 48 × 63 cm
- 2
- Family Reunion* • Bazille, 1867 • 152 × 230 cm
- 3
- Women in the Garden* • Monet, 1866 • 255 × 205 cm
- 4
- Flood at Port-Marly* • Sisley, 1876 • 60 × 81 cm
- 5
- Hoarfrost* • Pissarro, 1873 • 65 × 93 cm
- 6
- The Magpie* • Monet, 1868–1869 • 89 × 130 cm
- 7
- Garden at Sainte-Adresse* • Monet, 1867 • 98 × 130 cm

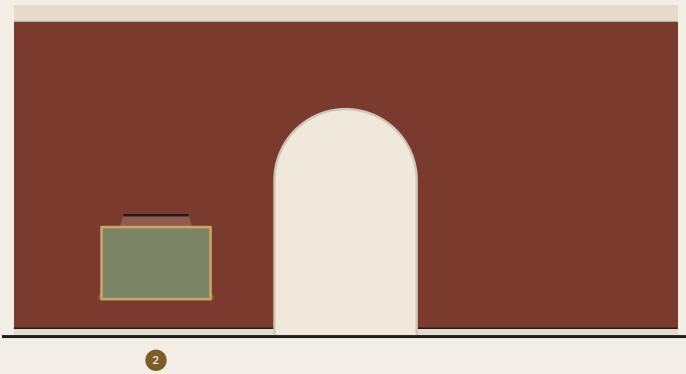
NORTH WALL



SOUTH WALL



EAST END WALL • THE DOOR FROM THE ROTUNDA



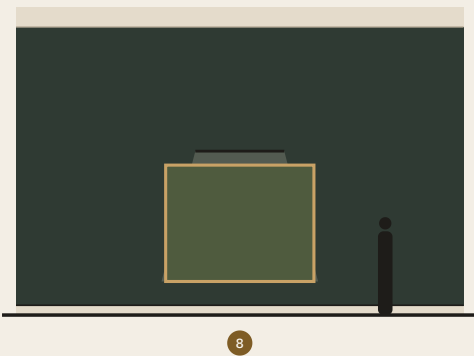
CABINET • 1863–1882

Around the Group: Manet

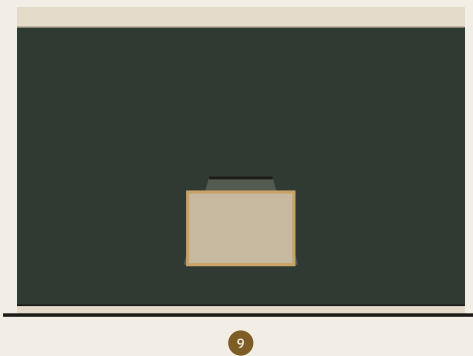
CABINET GREEN • #2F3A33

- 8
- Luncheon on the Grass* • Manet, 1863 • 208 × 265 cm
- 9
- Olympia* • Manet, 1863 • 130 × 190 cm
- 10
- A Bar at the Folies-Bergère* • Manet, 1882 • 96 × 130 cm

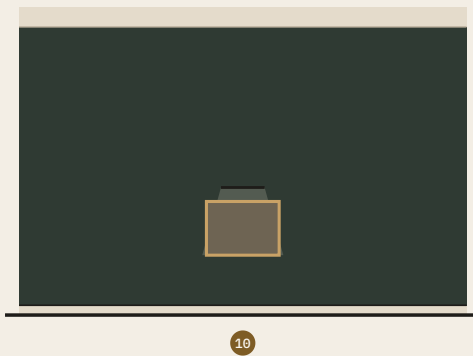
NORTH • FACING THE DOOR



WEST



EAST



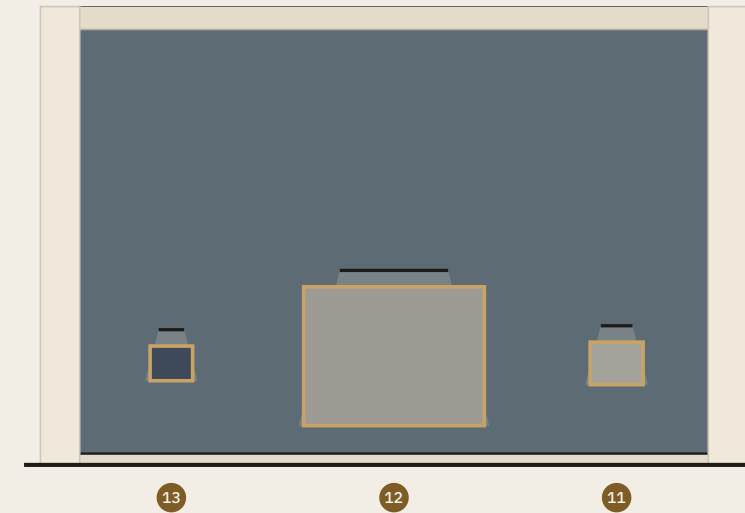


SALON IMPRESSION • BAY 2

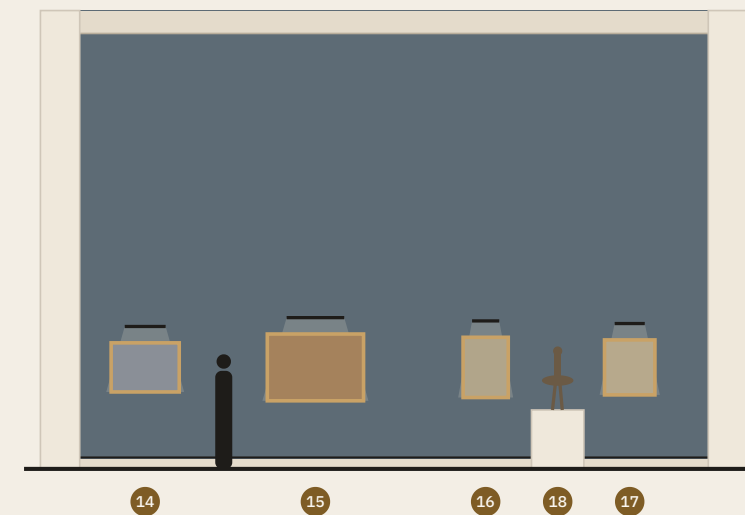
Modern Paris

Caillebotte's *Paris Street; Rainy Day* anchors the Paris-grey bay, flanked by Pissarro's boulevards; Degas's *Little Dancer* stands on her plinth.

NORTH WALL



SOUTH WALL



Leisure and Light · Women Impressionists

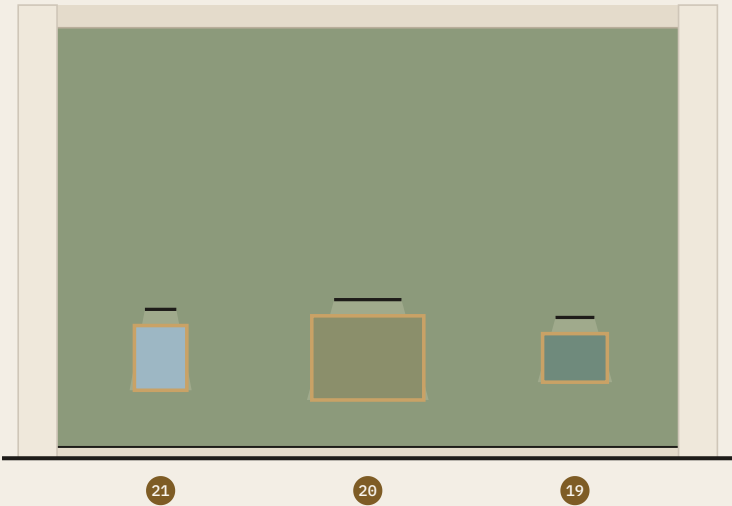
BAY 3 · 1869–1883

Leisure and Light

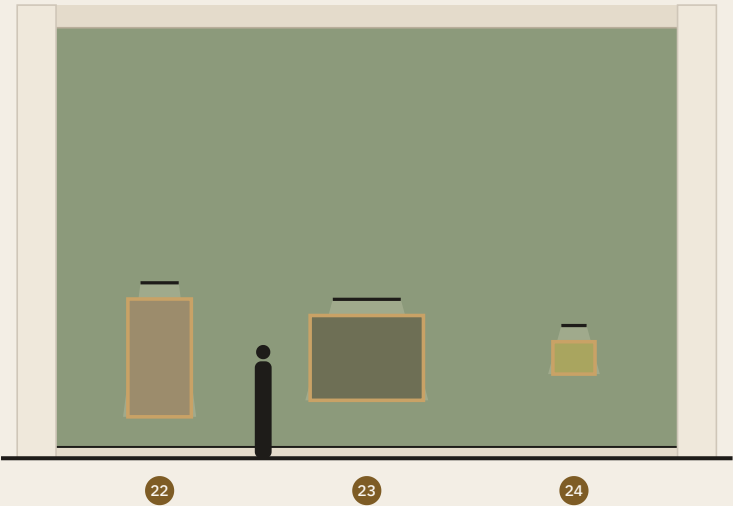
 SAGE · #8C9A7B

- 19 *La Grenouillère* · Monet, 1869 · 75 × 100 cm
- 20 *Luncheon of the Boating Party* · Renoir, 1880–1881 · 130 × 173 cm
- 21 *Woman with a Parasol – Madame Monet and Her Son* · Monet, 1875 · 100 × 81 cm
- 22 *Dance at Bougival* · Renoir, 1883 · 182 × 98 cm
- 23 *Bal du moulin de la Galette* · Renoir, 1876 · 131 × 175 cm
- 24 *Poppy Field* · Monet, 1873 · 50 × 65 cm

NORTH WALL



SOUTH WALL



BAY 4 · 1869–1894

Women Impressionists

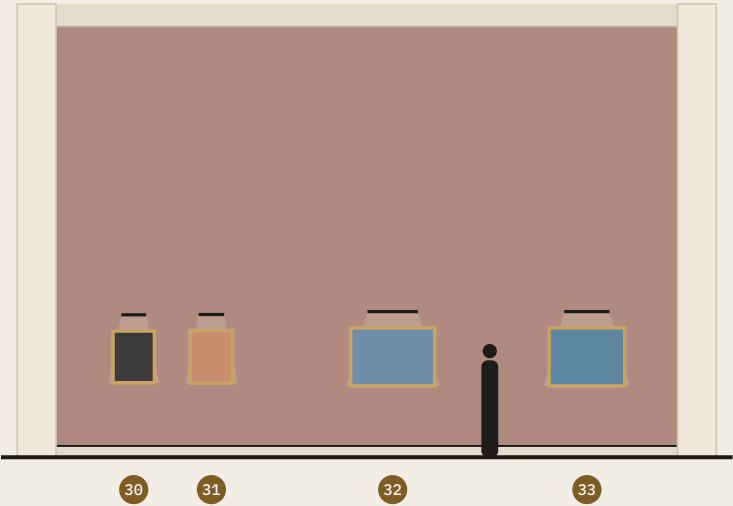
 DUSTY ROSE · #B08A80

- 25 *The Harbor at Lorient* · Morisot, 1869 · 44 × 73 cm
- 26 *Summer's Day* · Morisot, 1879 · 46 × 75 cm
- 27 *The Cradle* · Morisot, 1872 · 56 × 46 cm
- 28 *In the Dining Room* · Morisot, 1886 · 61 × 50 cm
- 29 *The Child's Bath* · Cassatt, 1893 · 100 × 66 cm
- 30 *La Loge* · Renoir, 1874 · 80 × 64 cm
- 31 *In the Loge* · Cassatt, 1878 · 81 × 66 cm
- 32 *Little Girl in a Blue Armchair* · Cassatt, 1878 · 90 × 130 cm
- 33 *The Boating Party* · Cassatt, 1893–1894 · 90 × 117 cm

NORTH WALL



SOUTH WALL



Monet's Series, then the Water Lilies

BAY 5 · 1890–1926

Monet's Series

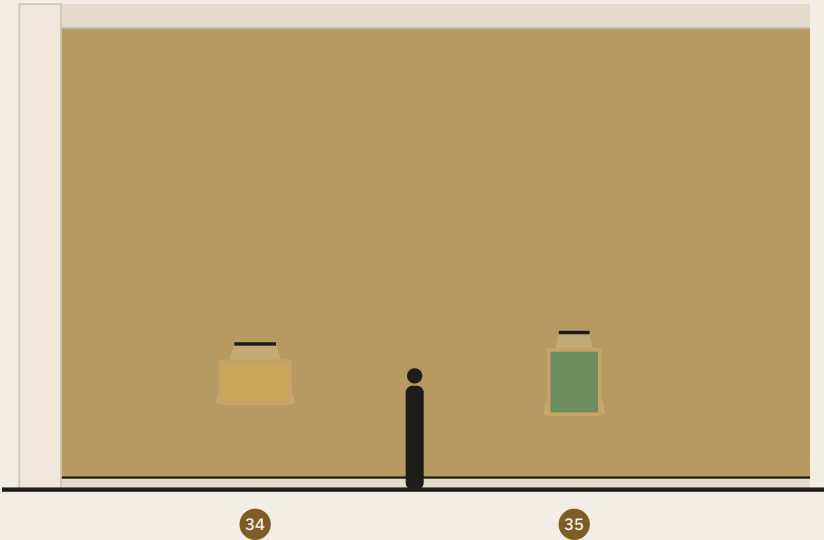
OCHRE · #B79A62

- 34 *Stacks of Wheat (End of Summer)* · Monet, 1890–1891 · 60 × 100 cm
- 35 *Bridge over a Pond of Water Lilies* · Monet, 1899 · 93 × 74 cm
- 36 *Rouen Cathedral series* · Monet, 1892–1894 · 5 canvases, c. 100 × 65 cm each

NORTH WALL · FIVE ROUEN CATHEDRALS



SOUTH WALL



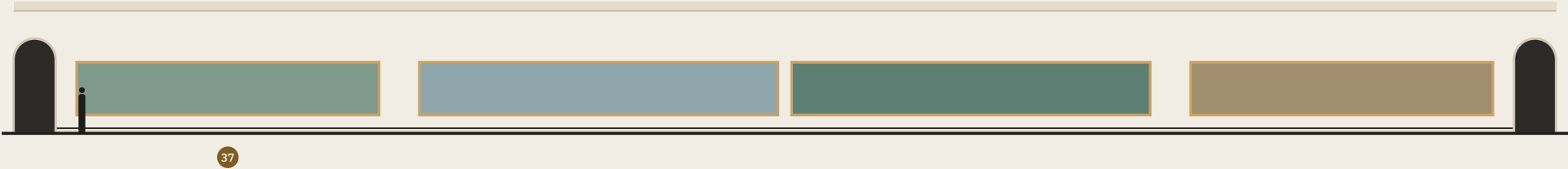
OVAL · 1914–1926

The Nymphéas Oval

LIME WHITE · #F1EDE4

- 37 *Water Lilies cycle* · Monet, 1914–1926 · 4 panels, 2 m tall

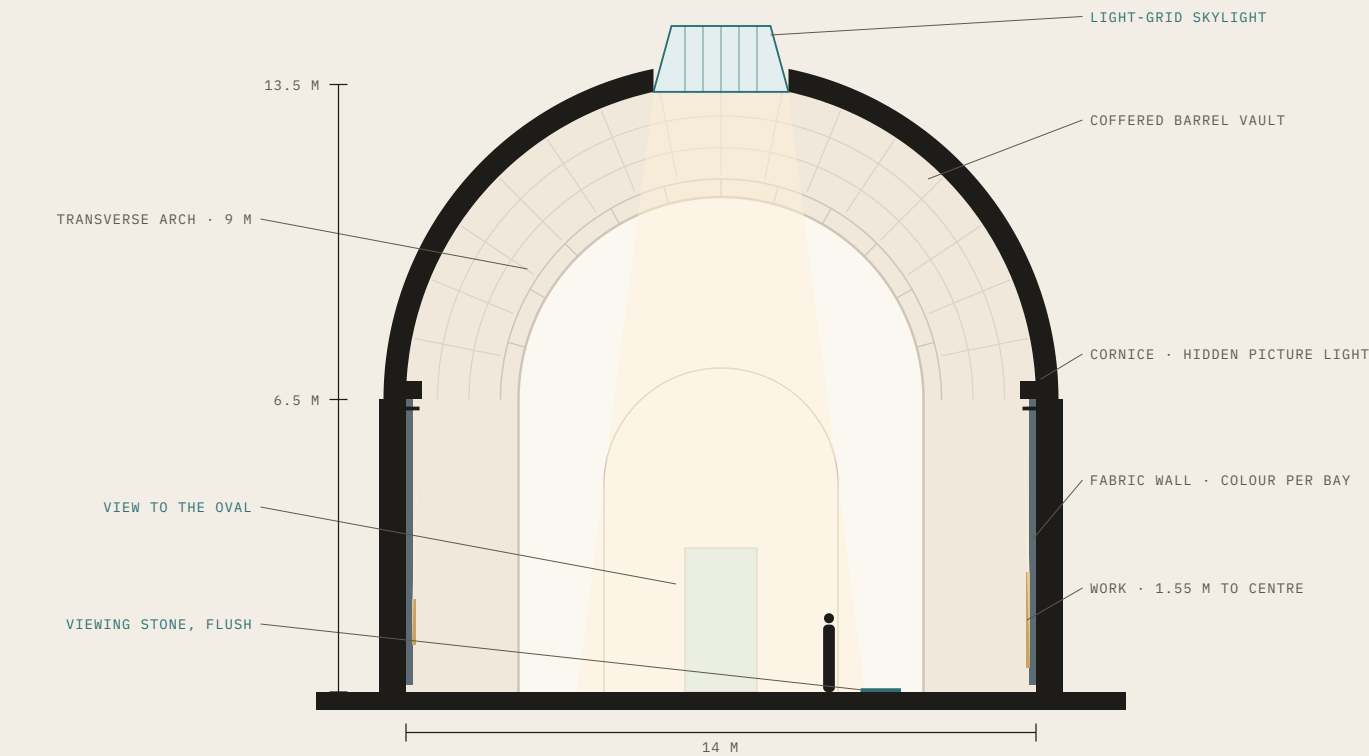
THE OVAL · ALL WALLS UNROLLED FROM THE DOOR · 59 M



Morning, The Clouds, Green Reflections, Setting Sun: the cycle wraps the whole room, and the Salon ends here. There is only one door.

How a bay is built

TRANSVERSE SECTION THROUGH BAY 2 · LOOKING WEST

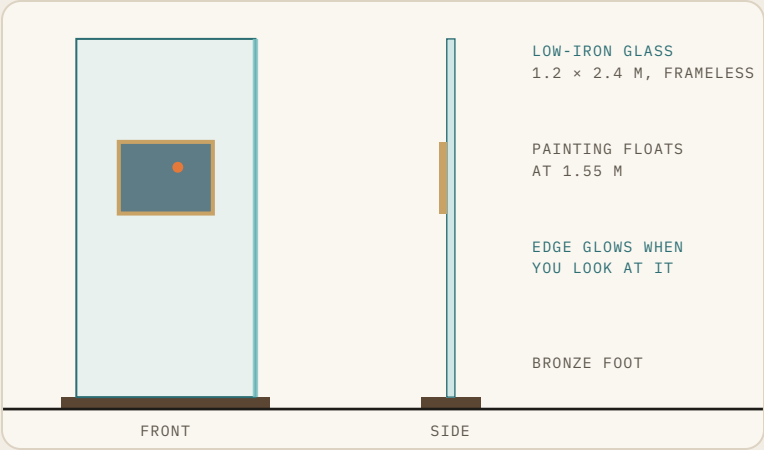


The modern and future touches are in the details: a light-grid skylight, a glass stele, stones and placards that answer your gaze.

WALL COLOURS · ONE PER CHAPTER

Oxblood	Cabinet green	Paris grey	Sage
BAY 1	CABINET	BAY 2	BAY 3
Dusty rose	Ochre	Lime white	
BAY 4	BAY 5	OVAL	

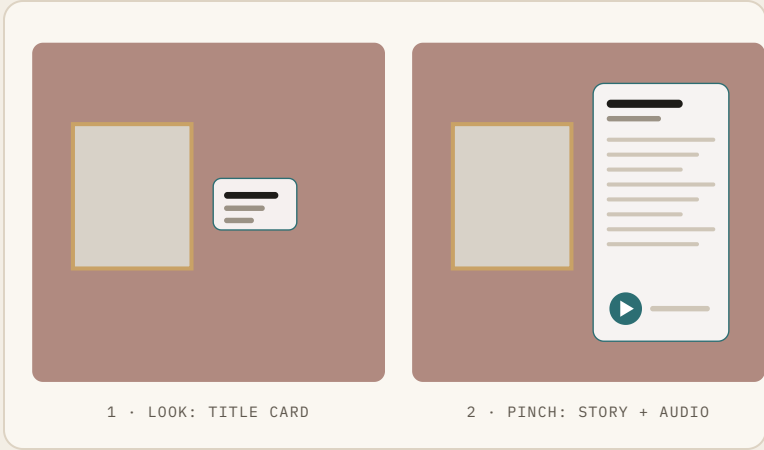
THE GLASS STELE · WORK 1



THE VIEWING STONE · LOOK, THEN PINCH



THE GLASS PLACARD · TITLE, THEN STORY





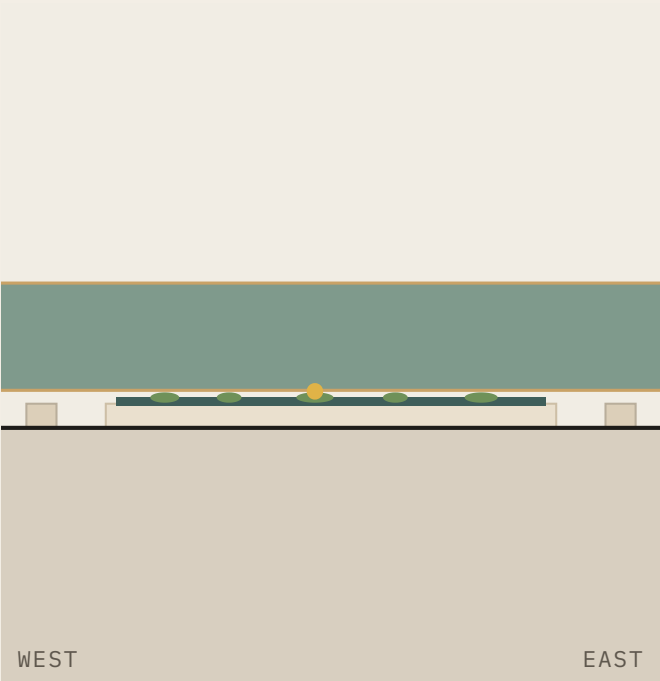
SALON IMPRESSION · THE FINALE

The Nymphéas Oval

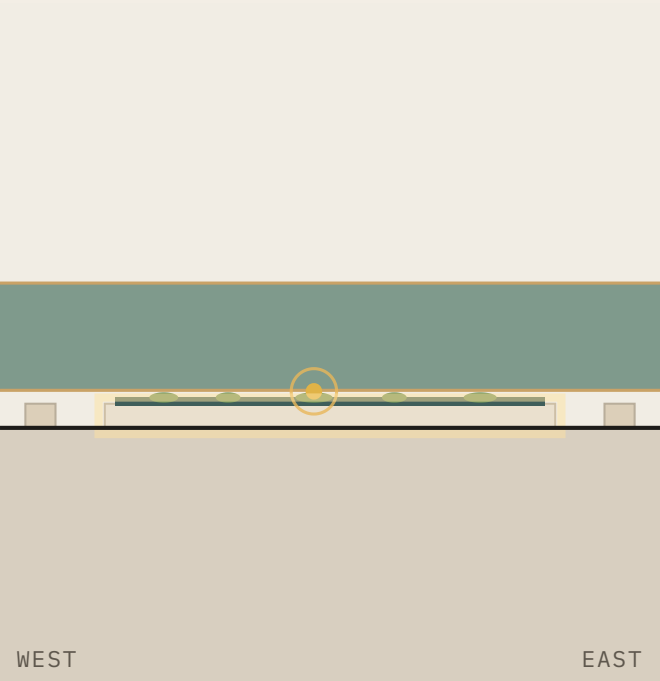
Monet's Water Lilies wrap the walls under a fabric velarium. At the centre, a shallow pond of living water lilies, ringed by four curved stone benches that face the panels. One flower is gold.

There is no door

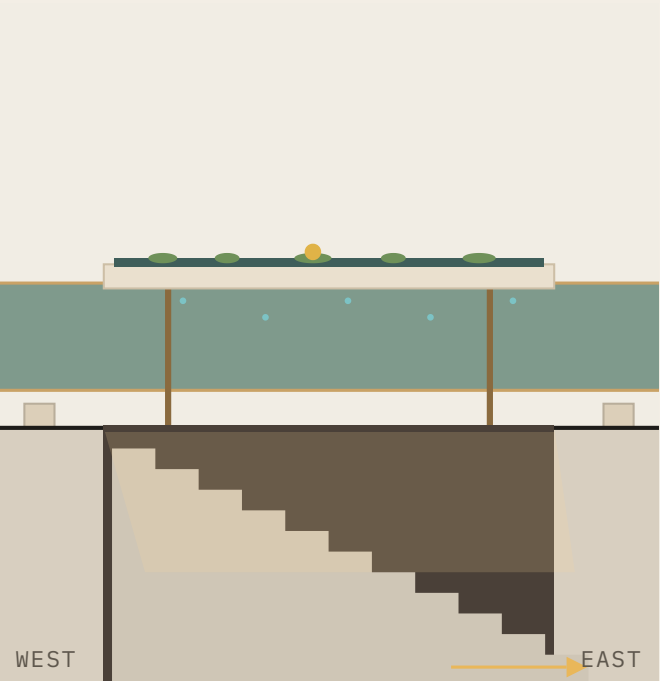
THE WAY DOWN · ELEVATION ACROSS THE POND, LOOKING NORTH



1 · A STILL POND
Living water lilies in a low travertine basin, ringed by four benches. One flower is gold.



2 · LOOK AT THE GOLDEN LILY
Hold your gaze on it for two seconds and a line of warm light runs round the rim.



3 · PINCH
The whole pond rises on four bronze posts. Below it, a long stair drops away east, towards the Salon.

2.6 m

THE POND LIFTS

36

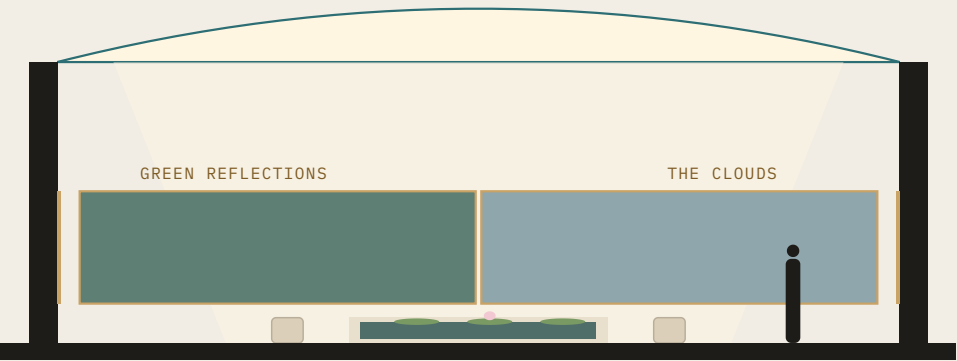
STEPS DOWN, ~12 M RUN

O

DOORS IN THE OVAL WALL

THE OVAL · SECTION · LOOKING WEST

VELARIUM · CLOUDS DRIFT ACROSS IT



LILY POND · SEATS FACE THE PANELS

Lower and softer than the bays

Panels hang 0.7 m above the floor so the water lilies sit at the level of your gaze, and daylight arrives through a fabric velarium with clouds drifting across it. The seats face the panels, not the pond.



SALON IMPRESSION • LEVEL -1

The Reserve

A 60-metre brick-vaulted cellar beneath the entire Salon, where every work not on the walls waits on sliding racks. Pinch a rack's handle and it glides into the aisle; carry a painting to the viewing easel under Bay 1, in a single warm light.

2.6 m

36

60 m

13

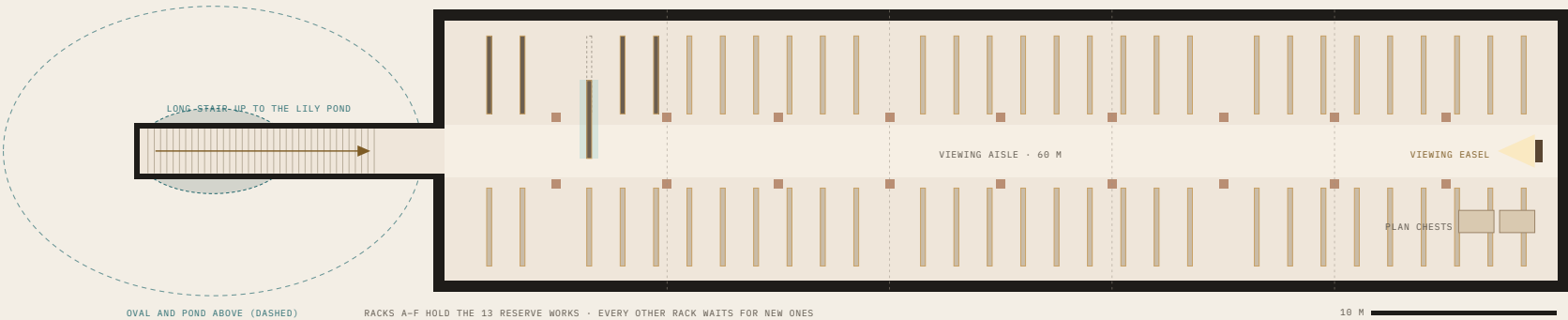
POND LIFT

STEPS DOWN

OF RESERVE

WORKS

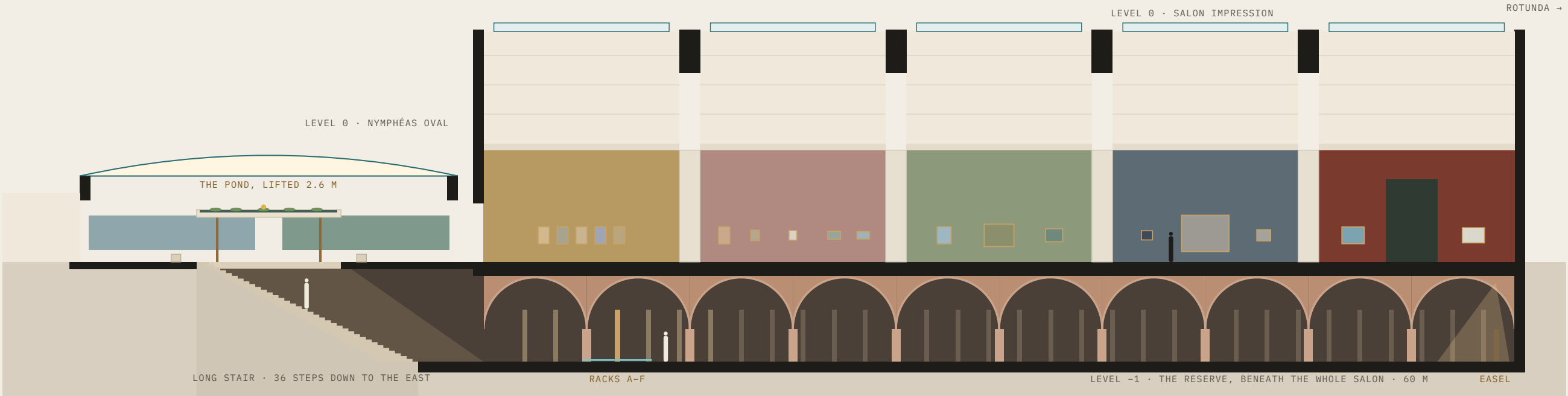
PLAN • LEVEL -1 • NORTH UP



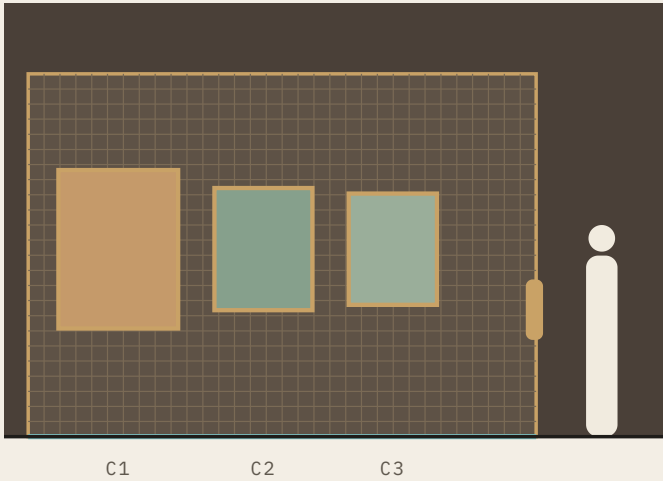
What is down here

Racks A to E hold the thirteen works not hung upstairs; the Degas pastels lie flat in plan chests, in low light. Rack F and the rest wait for new acquisitions.

LONG SECTION ALONG THE AXIS • LOOKING NORTH • THE SALON ABOVE, THE RESERVE BELOW



RACK C • PULLED OUT • AT TRUE SCALE



RACK A *Le Pont de l'Europe* · Caillebotte, 1876 · 125 × 180 cm
Young Man at His Window · Caillebotte, 1876 · 116 × 81 cm

RACK C *Acrobats at the Cirque Fernando (Francisca and Angelina Wartenberg)* · Renoir, 1879 · 131 × 99 cm
Two Sisters (On the Terrace) · Renoir, 1881 · 101 × 81 cm
The Swing · Renoir, 1876 · 92 × 73 cm

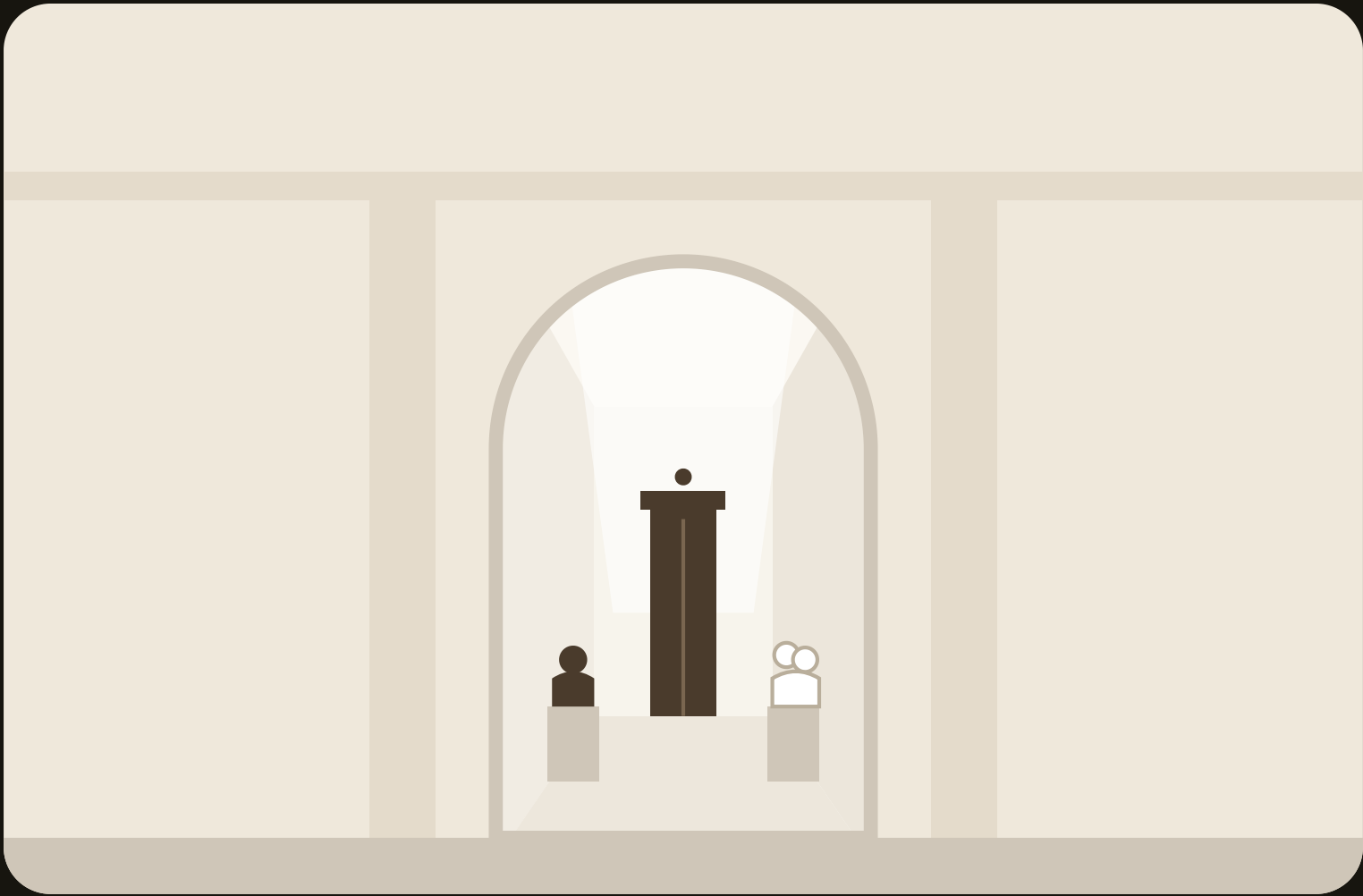
RACK E *The Bridge at Villeneuve-la-Garenne* · Sisley, 1872 · 50 × 65 cm
Snow at Louveciennes · Sisley, 1878 · 61 × 51 cm

CHEST *The Star* · Degas, c. 1878 · pastel · 58 × 42 cm
The Tub · Degas, 1886 · pastel · 60 × 83 cm
Works on paper lie flat, in low light.

RACK B *Place de la Concorde* · Degas, 1875 · 78 × 118 cm
The Orchestra at the Opera · Degas, c. 1870 · 57 × 46 cm

RACK D *Red Roofs* · Pissarro, 1877 · 55 × 66 cm
Avenue de l'Opéra, Snow Effect · Pissarro, 1898 · 65 × 81 cm

RACK F Empty, kept for new acquisitions



Back on the sun, turn north. Through the door, The Gates of Hell close the view.

Sculpture Hall

One top-lit court, 17 m square, north of the Rotunda. Ten works from Rude to Bourdelle, 1833–1909, with Rodin at the heart. Every one comes from an open 3D scan.

16.8 m

SQUARE COURT

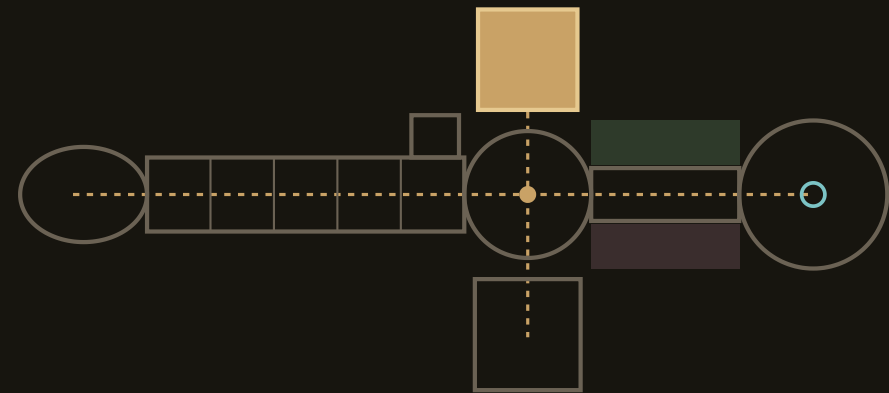
10

WORKS

30 m

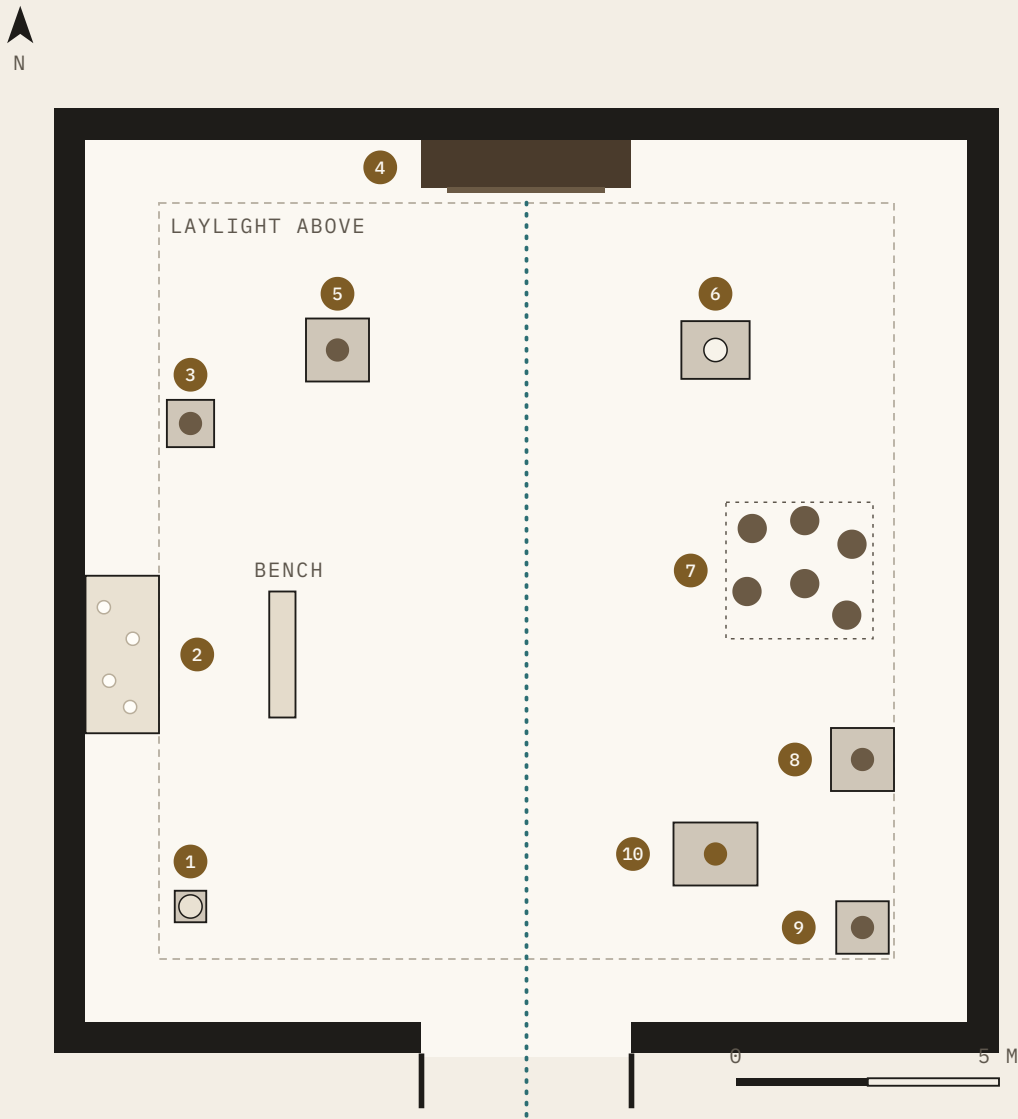
SUN TO THE GATES

WHERE YOU ARE



One court, ten works

PLAN · NORTH UP



FROM THE ROTUNDA · THE SUN ROSETTE IS 30 M FROM THE GATES

A glass roof over a laylight at 10 m. Nothing stands on the axis: from the sun rosette you look straight through the north door at The Gates of Hell.

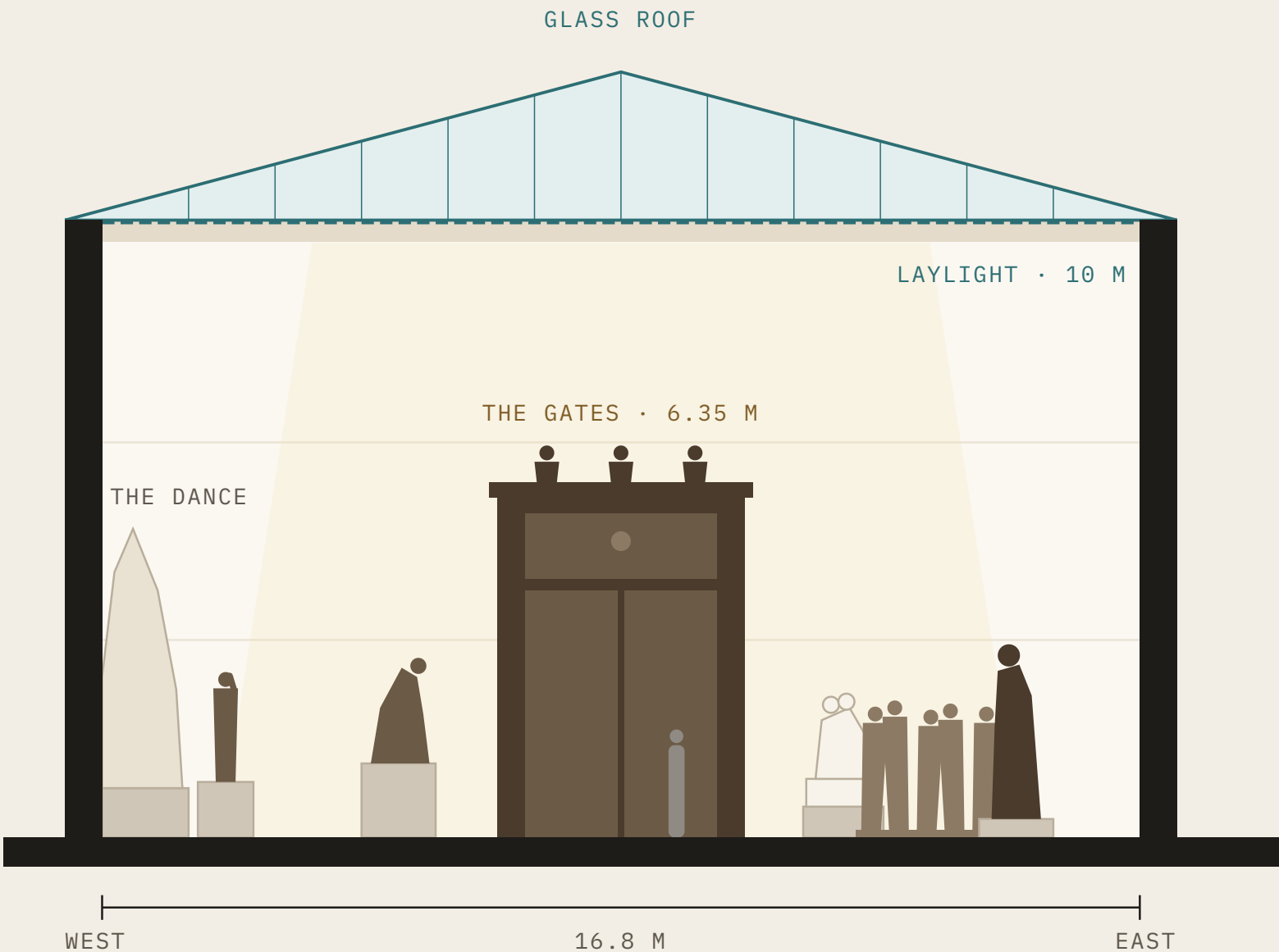
THE TEN WORKS · RUDE TO BOURDELLE, 1833–1909 · ONLY OPEN SCANS

- 1 RUDE · 1833–1836
La Marseillaise (head)
Stone high relief · head only
CC-BY · [PLASTER CAST OF THE HEAD](#)
- 2 CARPEAUX · 1865–1869
The Dance
Échaillon stone · 4.20 m
CC-BY · [OPÉRA FAÇADE COPY](#)
- 3 RODIN · 1875–1877
The Age of Bronze
Bronze · 1.78 m
CC0 · [CLEVELAND MUSEUM OF ART](#)
- 4 RODIN · 1880–1917
The Gates of Hell
Plaster (Orsay); bronze casts from 1926 · 6.35 m
CC-BY · [STANFORD BRONZE](#)
- 5 RODIN · 1880
The Thinker
Bronze · 1.80 m
CC-BY · [NY CARLSBERG GLYPTOTEK](#)
- 6 RODIN · c.1882
The Kiss
Marble · 1.81 m
CC-BY · [MUSÉE RODIN MARBLE](#)
- 7 RODIN · 1884–1889
The Burghers of Calais
Bronze · 2.02 m
CC-BY · [FULL GROUP](#)
- 8 RODIN · 1898
Monument to Balzac
Bronze · 2.82 m
CC-BY · [MIDDELHEIM, ANTWERP](#)
- 9 RODIN · c.1900
The Walking Man
Bronze · 2.13 m
CC-BY 4.0 · [NORTON SIMON, UNTEXTURED](#)
- 10 BOURDELLE · 1909
Hercules the Archer
Gilt bronze · 2.48 m
CC-BY · [MET CAST](#)

Looking north to the Gates

Carpeaux’s La Danse holds the west wall; the six Burghers stand at floor level on the east side; Bourdelle’s Heracles draws his bow by the door.

SECTION · GLASS ROOF OVER A LAYLIGHT AT 10 M



One axis, one destination

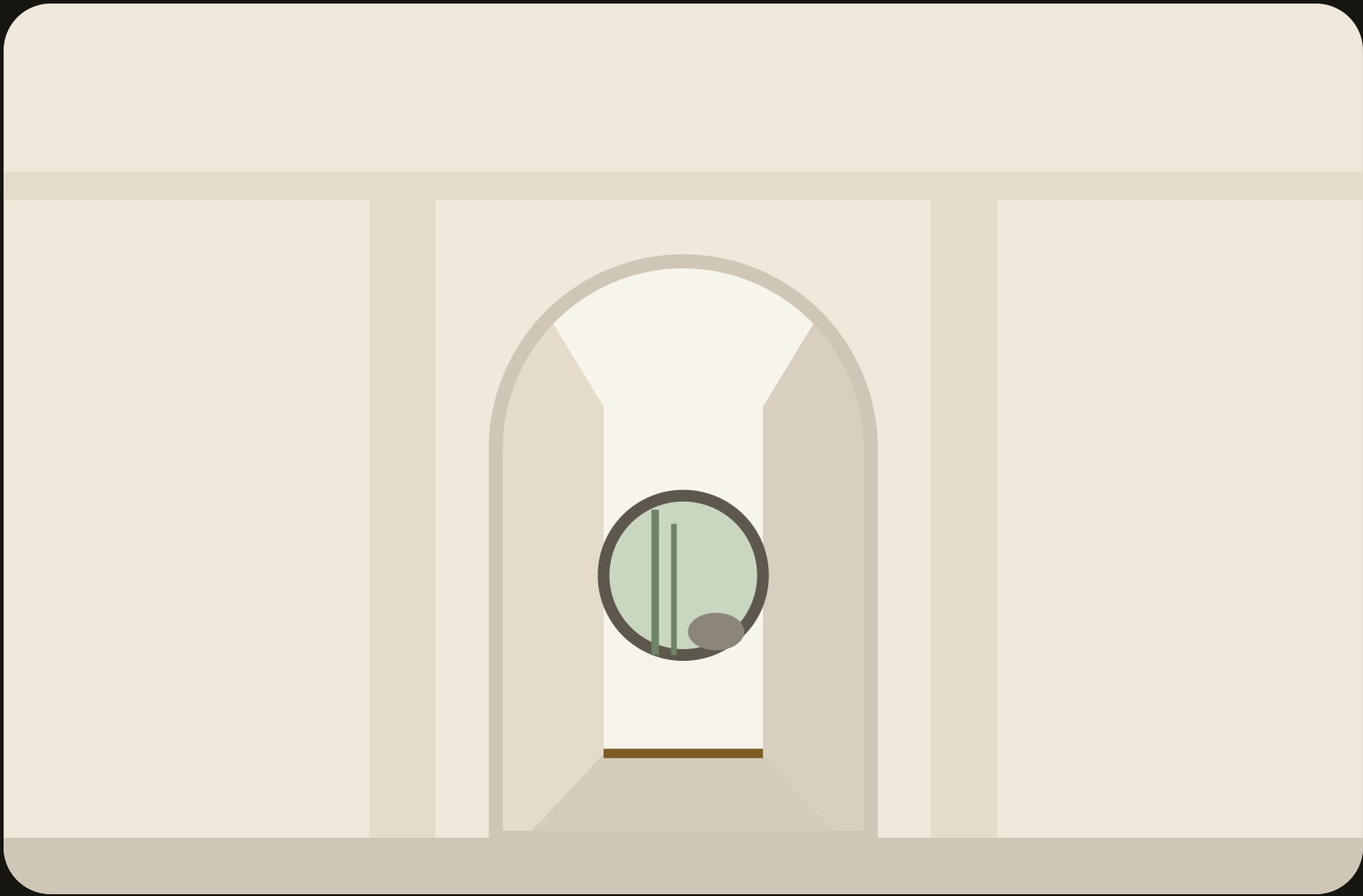
From the sun rosette you look through the north door straight at The Gates of Hell, 30 m away. Nothing stands on the axis.

The Gates’ two children

The Thinker and The Kiss began as figures on the Gates. They stand either side of it, back beside where they started.

No pedestal for the Burghers

The six burghers stand on the floor, as Rodin wanted, so you walk in among them at their own height.



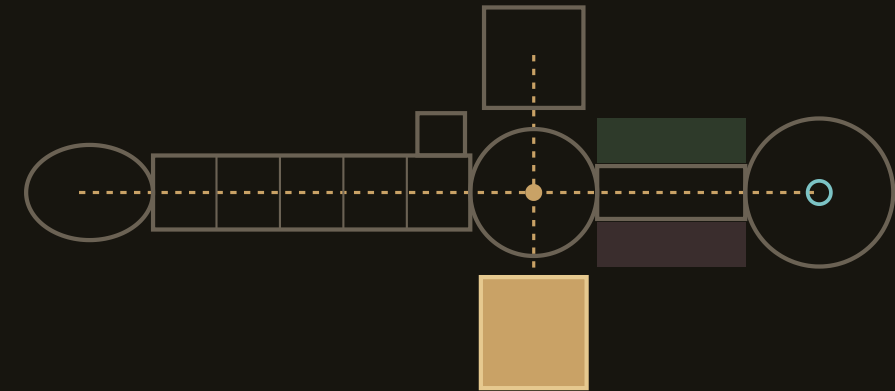
Turn south. Past the stele that names today’s solar term, the moon gate frames the garden and the sky. The Rotunda keeps the hour; this garden keeps the season.

The Chinese Wing 四時園

Through a moon gate off the Rotunda: a whitewashed cloister on three sides of an open garden, the Garden of the Four Seasons, after the courtyards of Suzhou and the Met’s Astor Court.

Ø 3.6 m 13 24
MOON GATE WORKS SOLAR TERMS

WHERE YOU ARE



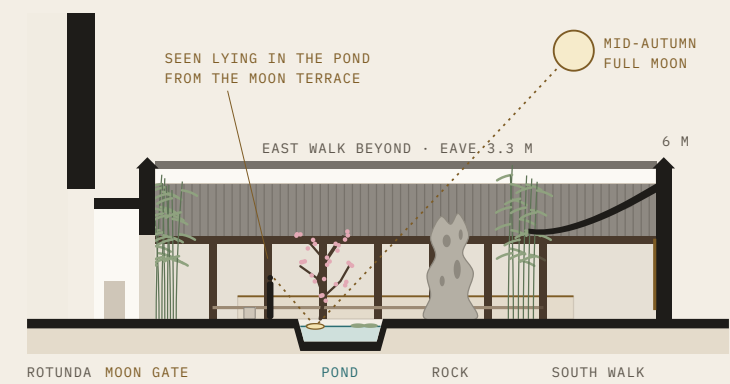
Through the moon gate

The moon gate frames the Taihu rock on the axis; the hanging scrolls glow under the south eave. The plaque reads right to left: Sì Shí Yuán.

FROM THE ROTUNDA'S SOUTH DOOR



SECTION · ON THE AXIS, LOOKING EAST



The moon in the pond

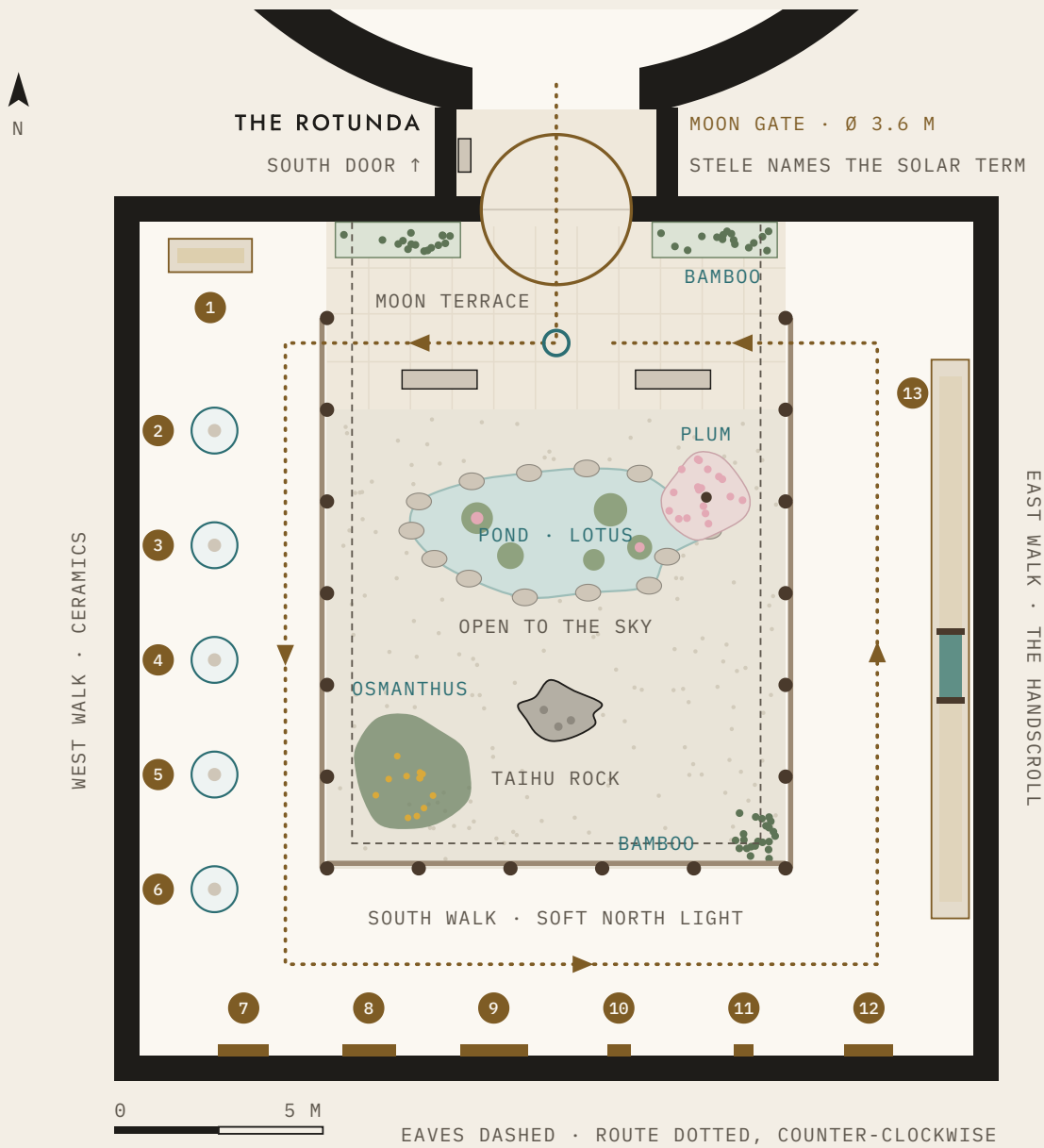
At night the real moon, on its real phase, clears the south wall. From the terrace you see it lying in the pond, as the gardens of Suzhou intended.

The brush comes first

The first thing inside is the Orchid Pavilion Preface, Feng Chengsu's Tang tracing of Wang Xizhi, because in China the brush comes before the painting.

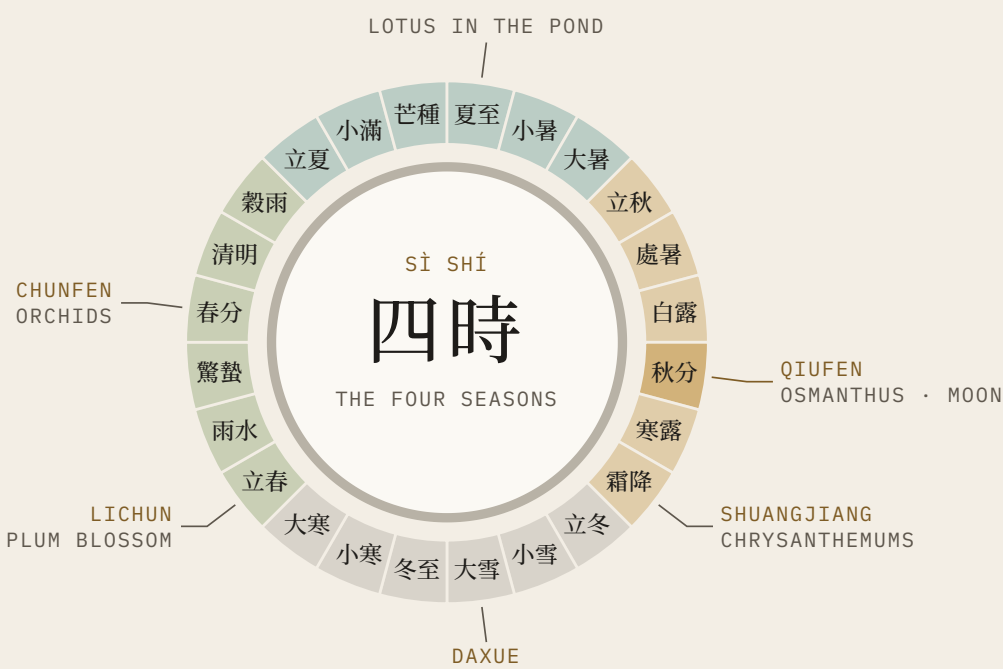
A cloister on three sides of a garden

PLAN · NORTH UP · ROUTE DOTTED, COUNTER-CLOCKWISE



A whitewashed cloister on the west, south and east; the north side is an open moon terrace, so the gate frames sky. The route runs counter-clockwise round an 11 m garden.

THE GARDEN'S YEAR · 24 SOLAR TERMS

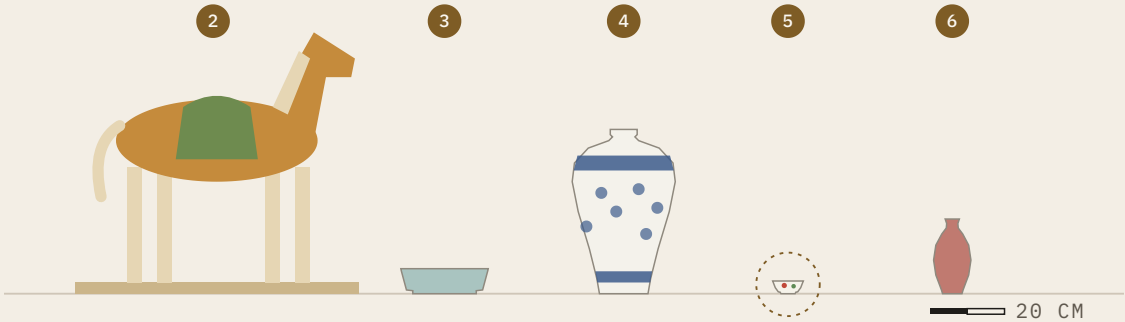


The garden keeps the season

The one touch of future. The open court follows the 24 solar terms and your local time: plum at Lichun, lotus at Xiazhi, snow on the rock at Daxue.

Ceramics, hanging scrolls, a handscroll

WEST WALK · FIVE CERAMICS, ONE SCALE, TANG TO QING



- 2

Sancai-glazed horse

TANG · 8TH C.
- 3

Ru ware narcissus basin

NORTHERN SONG
- 4

Blue-and-white meiping

YUAN
- 5

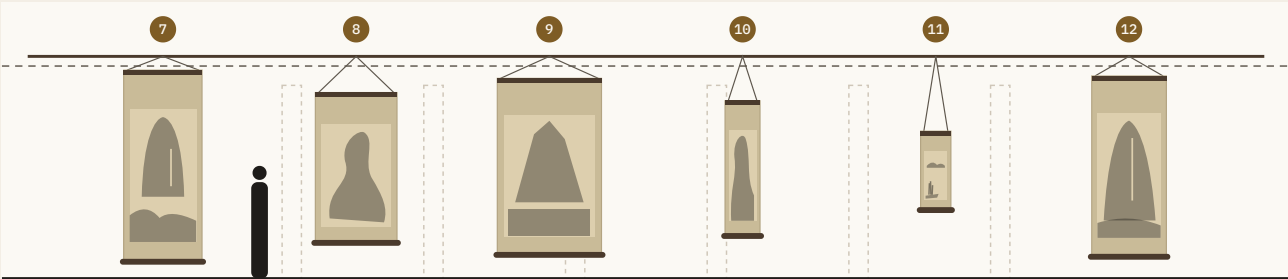
Doucai chicken cup

MING · THE ONE YOU MAY HOLD
- 6

Peachbloom amphora vase

QING · KANGXI

SOUTH WALK · SIX HANGING SCROLLS, SONG TO MING



- 7 · FAN KUAN

Travellers among Mountains and Streams

C. 1000
- 8 · GUO XI

Early Spring

1072
- 9 · LI TANG

Wind in Pines among a Myriad Valleys

1124
- 10 · WANG MENG

Dwelling in the Qingbian Mountains

1366
- 11 · NI ZAN

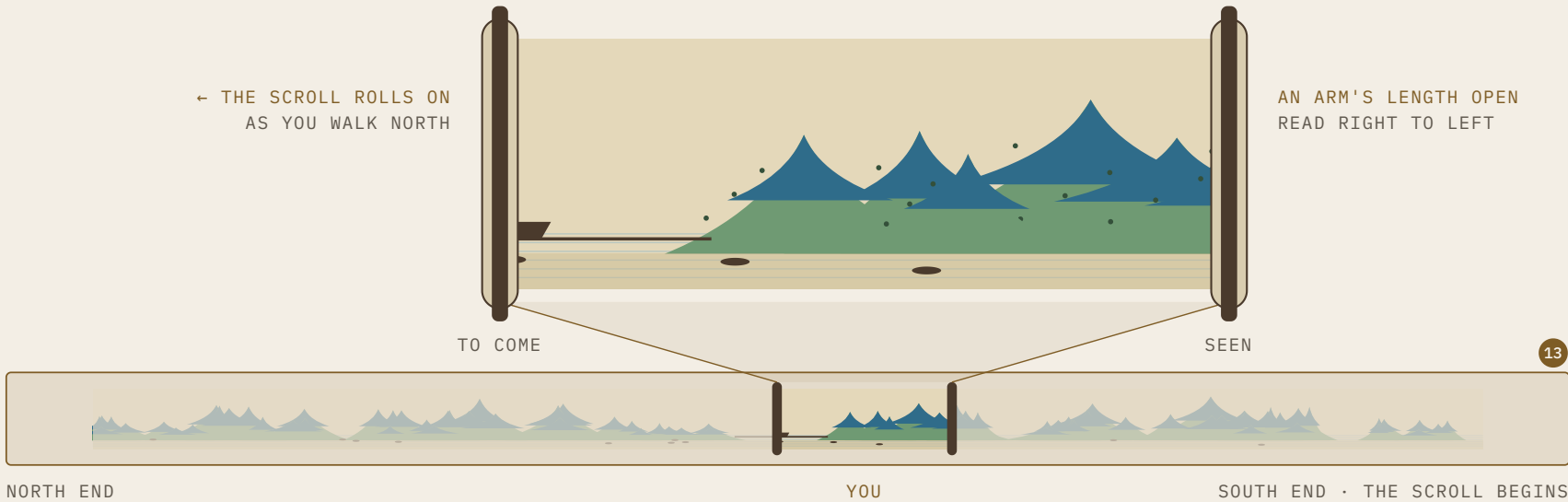
The Rongxi Studio

1372
- 12 · SHEN ZHOU

Lofty Mount Lu

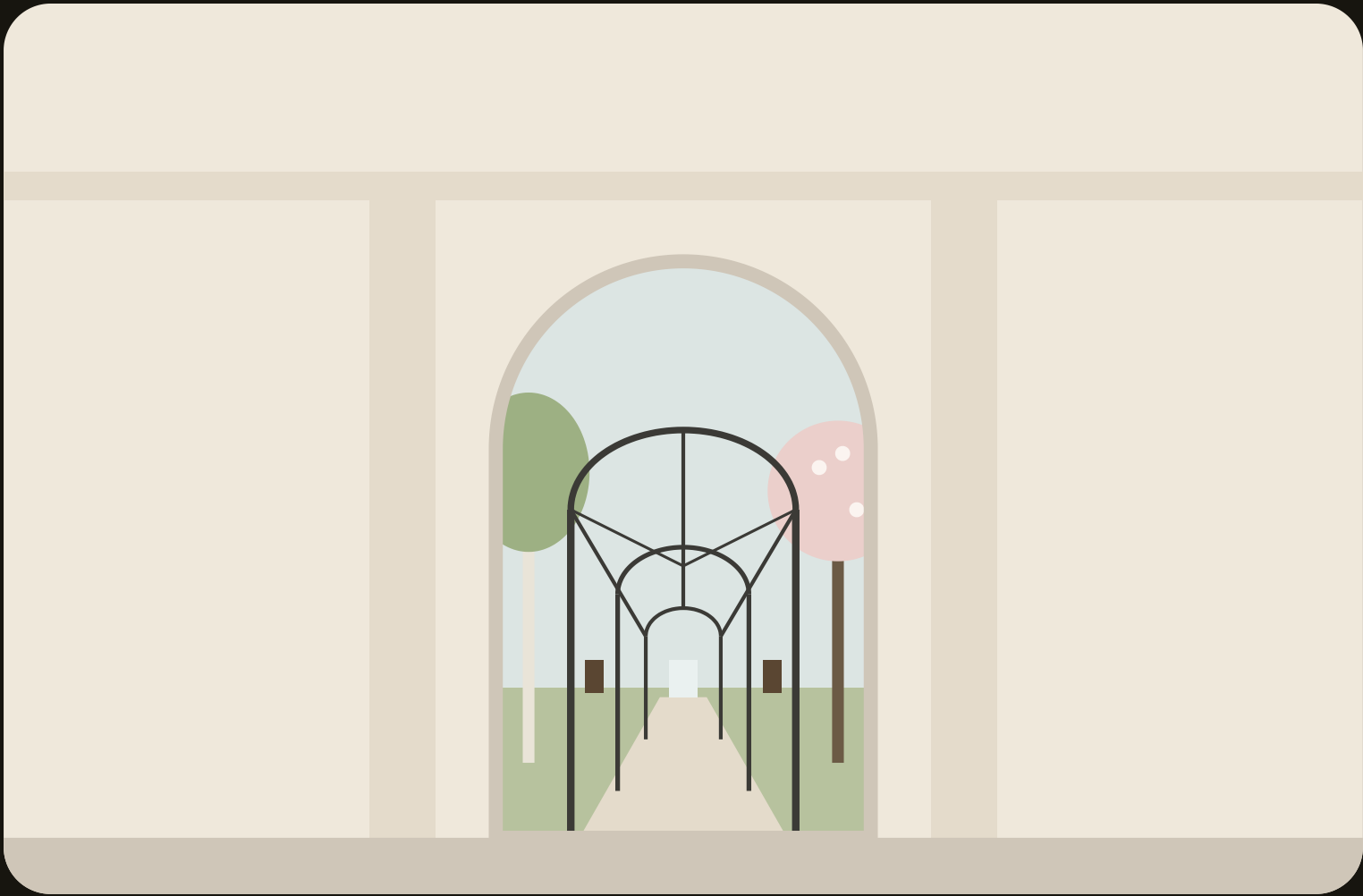
1467

EAST WALK · ONE HANDSCROLL, 11.9 M, AT SCALE



A scroll is read, not hung

Wang Ximeng's *A Thousand Li of Rivers and Mountains*, 1113, opens an arm's length at a time, right to left, rolling on as you walk north beside it.



The classical rooms are behind you. Turn east, the way on: the era changes to Modern · Alive.

Hall of Light

A glass hall 30 metres long and 9 wide, from the Rotunda to the Atrium between two gardens. The first photographs hang on the glass, with the garden growing behind them.

30 × 9 m

GLASS HALL

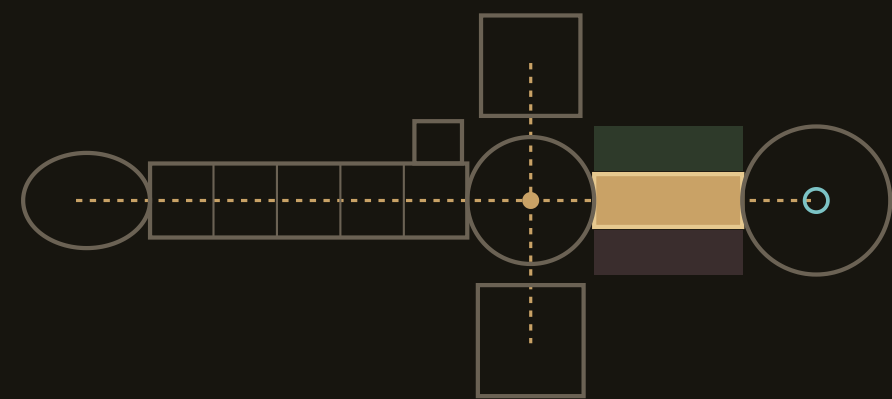
5

PHOTOGRAPHS

2

GARDENS

WHERE YOU ARE



Looking east, towards the Atrium

Glass from floor to roof: the Rotunda’s steel-and-glass lattice drawn out into a shallow vault. Outside, everything grows; rain drums on the lattice.



ON THE GLASS, WALKING FORWARD IN TIME →

A leaf
Fox Talbot, c. 1840

British Algae
Anna Atkins, 1843

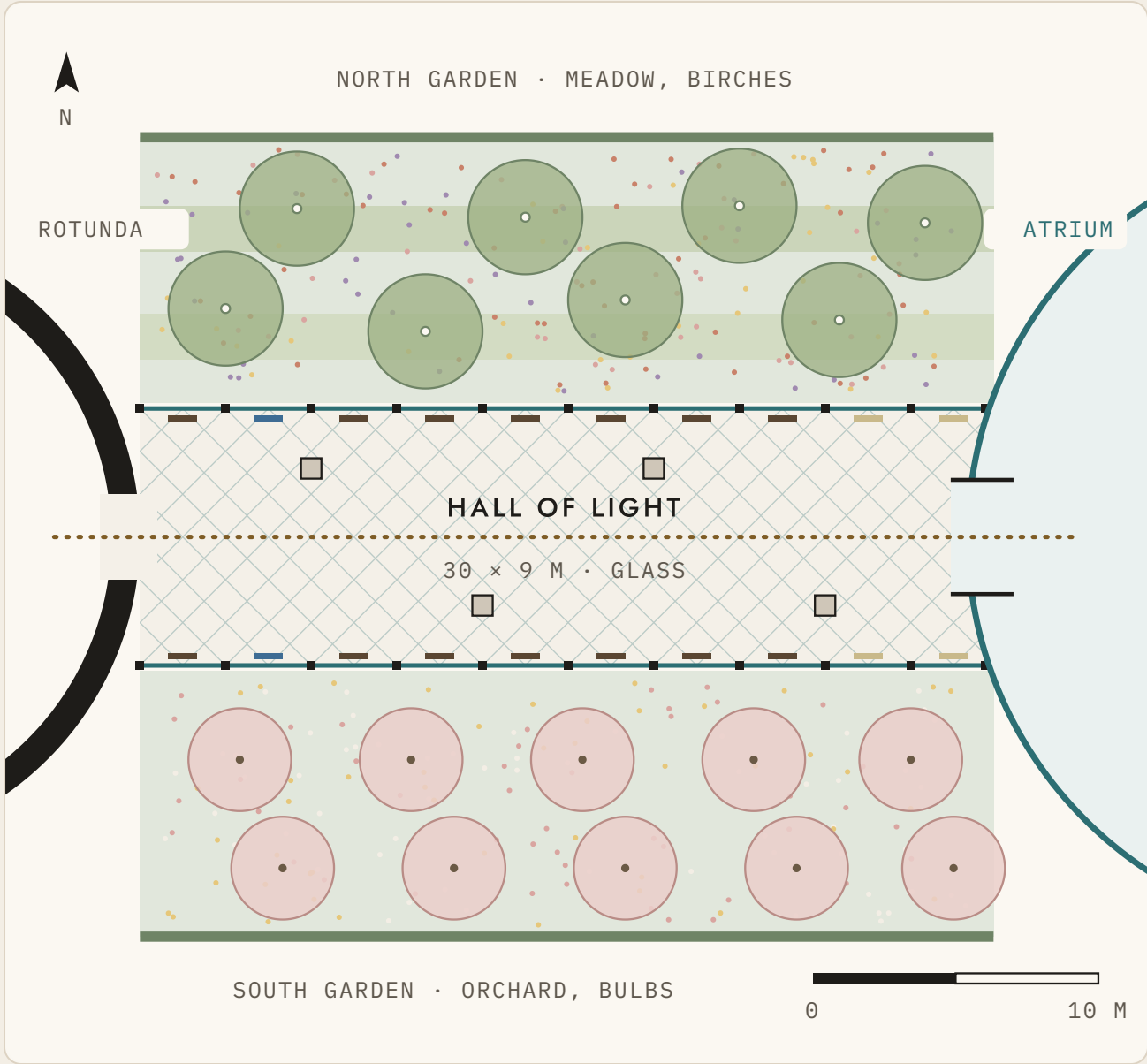
Sarah Bernhardt
Nadar, c. 1864

The Horse in Motion
Muybridge, 1878

Autochromes
Lumière, 1907

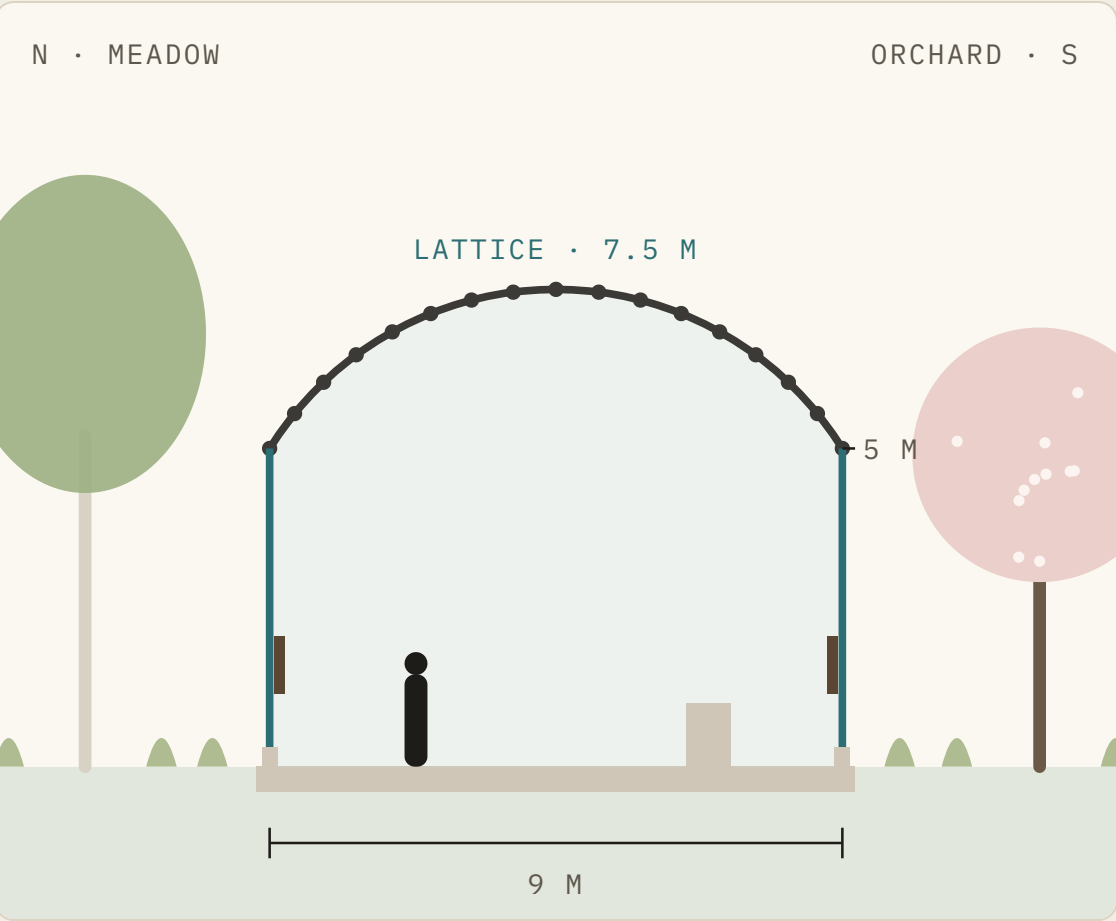
A hall between two gardens

PLAN · NORTH UP



North, a meadow of grasses and perennials under birches; south, a flowering orchard over bulbs. Hedges close both gardens, lined up with the Atrium's diameter.

CROSS-SECTION · LOOKING EAST

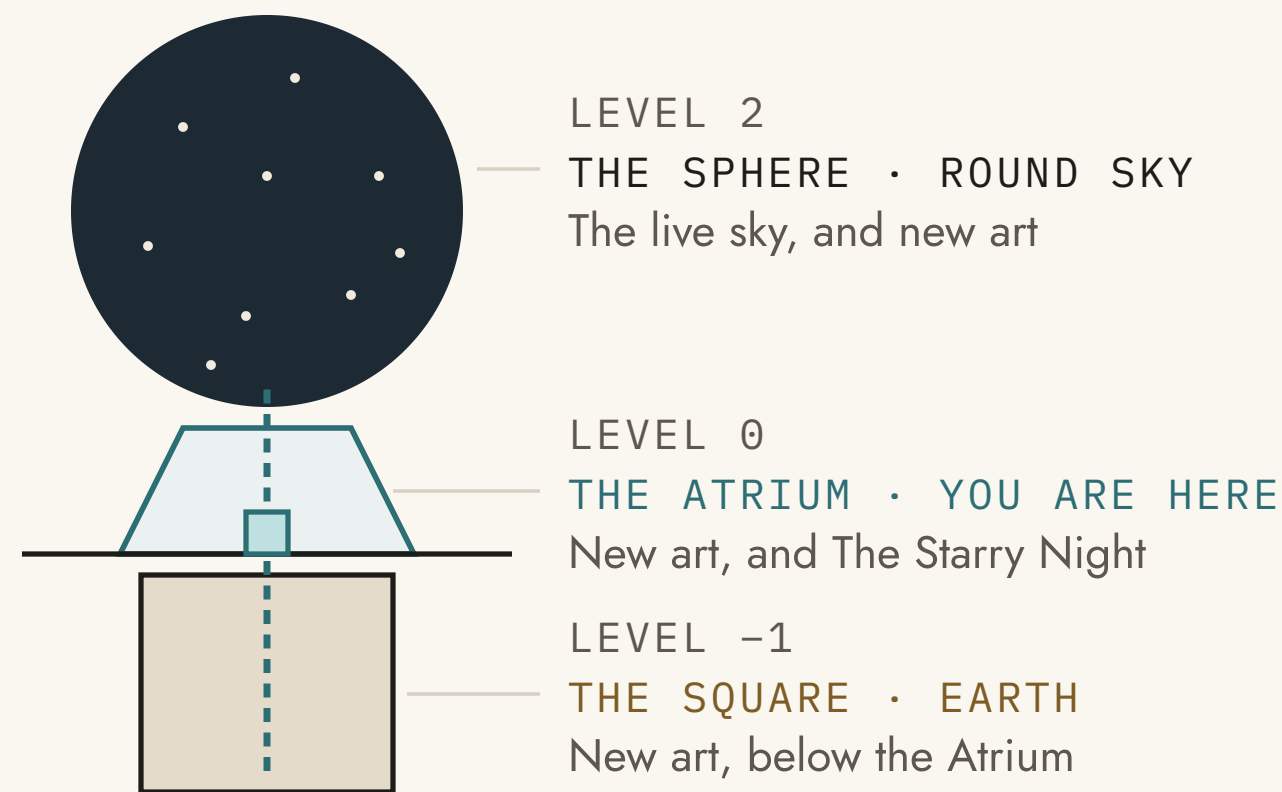


Prints on the glass

One print per 3 m bay, at eye level on a slim bronze-edged panel, with garden above, below and between. Here daylight cannot fade them.

A clear axis

Four stereo stones, each with an 1850s stereograph in 3D, stand off the centre. The view runs clear to the glass car and The Starry Night.



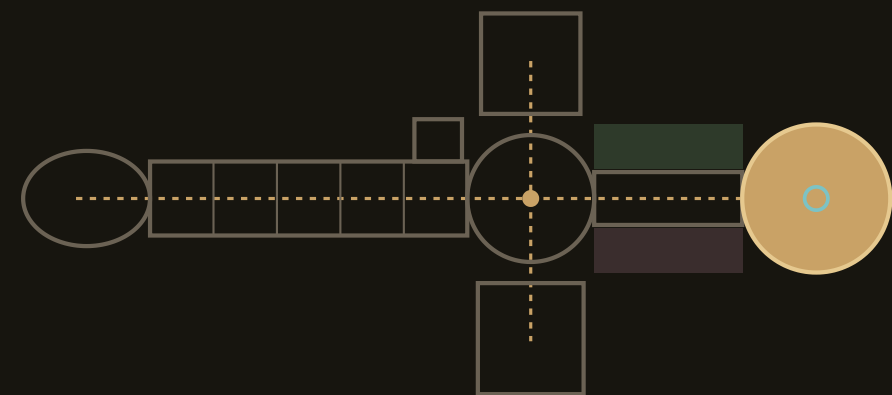
Round sky, square earth, 天圓地方. One glass car joins them: down to the earth first, then up to the stars.

Élan

Section II looks forward. Everything here is new art, our own commissions: under misty glass in the Atrium, in rammed earth in the Square below, and on the whole inside of the Sphere above.

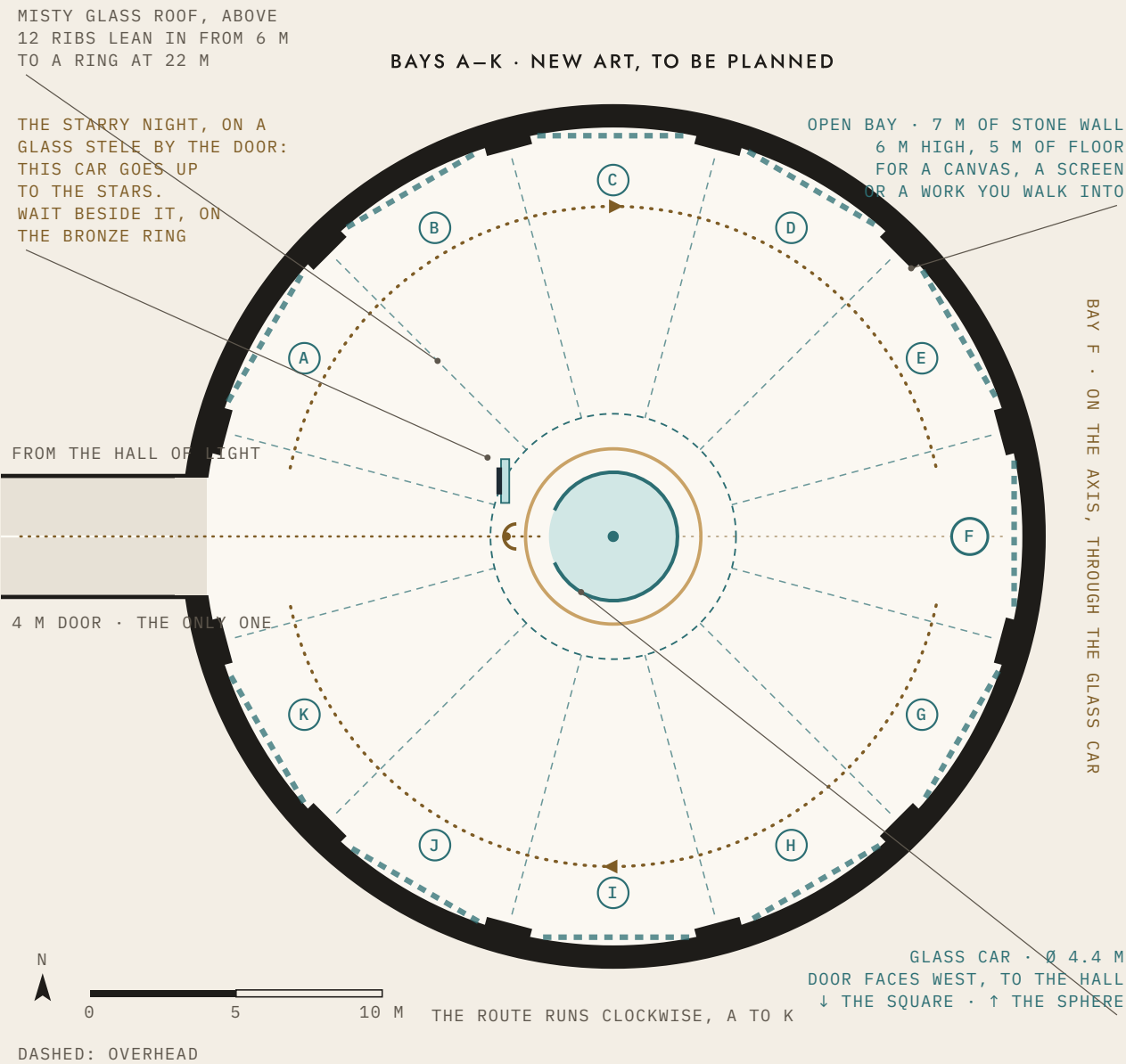
28 m 150 m 3
THE ATRIUM THE SPHERE LEVELS

WHERE YOU ARE



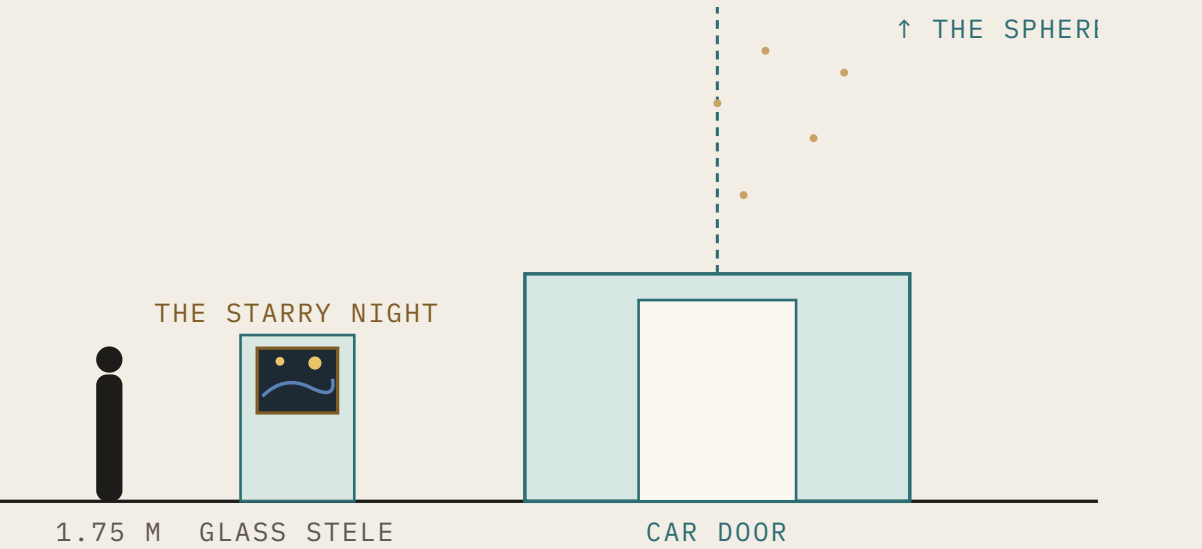
The Atrium

PLAN · BAYS A–K · NEW ART, TO BE PLANNED



A 28-metre circle of twelve bays under misty glass: one door from the Hall of Light, eleven bays kept for new art, and at the centre a glass elevator.

BY THE ELEVATOR · THE ONE PAINTING



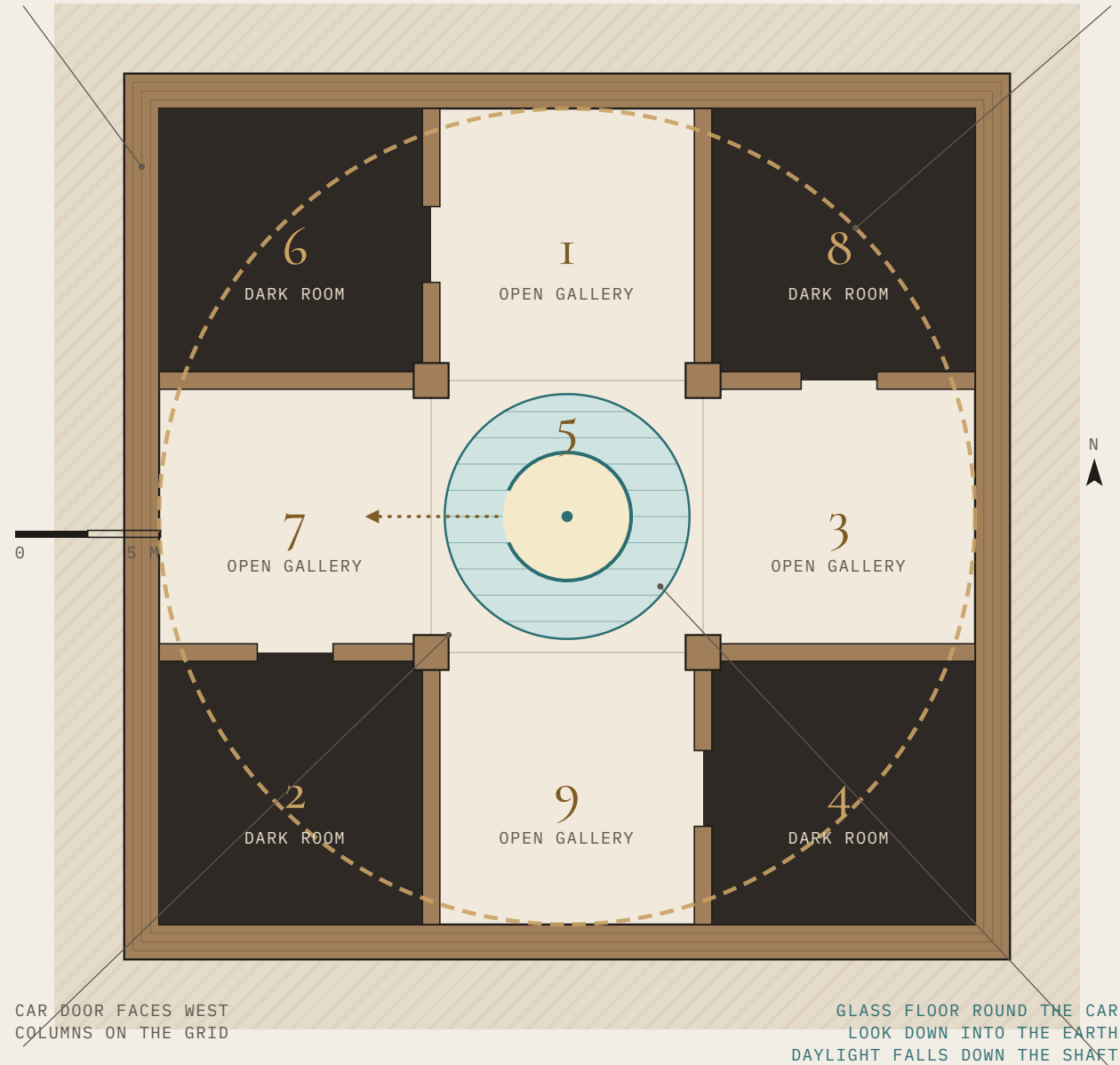
The Starry Night
VINCENT VAN GOGH, 1889 · MOMA, NEW YORK · 74 × 92 CM

A small square of night in a daylit room, on a glass stele beside the car door. It is the sign for the elevator: this car goes up to the stars.



RAMMED-EARTH WALLS
1.2 M, IN STRATA

RING OF LIGHT OVERHEAD:
THE ATRIUM'S CIRCLE ABOVE



6	1	8
7	5	3
2	9	4

Every row, column and diagonal adds up to 15. Five, the number of earth, sits at the centre, and that is where the car stops.

5

The car lands here. Glass floor over the earth; daylight down the shaft.

1 · 3 · 9 · 7

Open galleries, new art. West is straight ahead from the car door.

$$6 \cdot 8 \cdot 4 \cdot 2$$

Dark rooms for light, film and spatial work.

A cross-section diagram of the atrium floor and shaft. The diagram shows a central vertical shaft (5m wide) leading down from the atrium floor. The atrium floor is 28m wide and 7.5m high. The shaft is lined with rammed earth. The floor is made of glass. The shaft is surrounded by soil, clay, chalk, and bedrock. The diagram is labeled with dimensions and materials.

28 M

7.5 M

5

THE ATRIUM · LEVEL 0 ↑

ATRIUM FLOOR

RING OF LIGHT

RAMMED EARTH

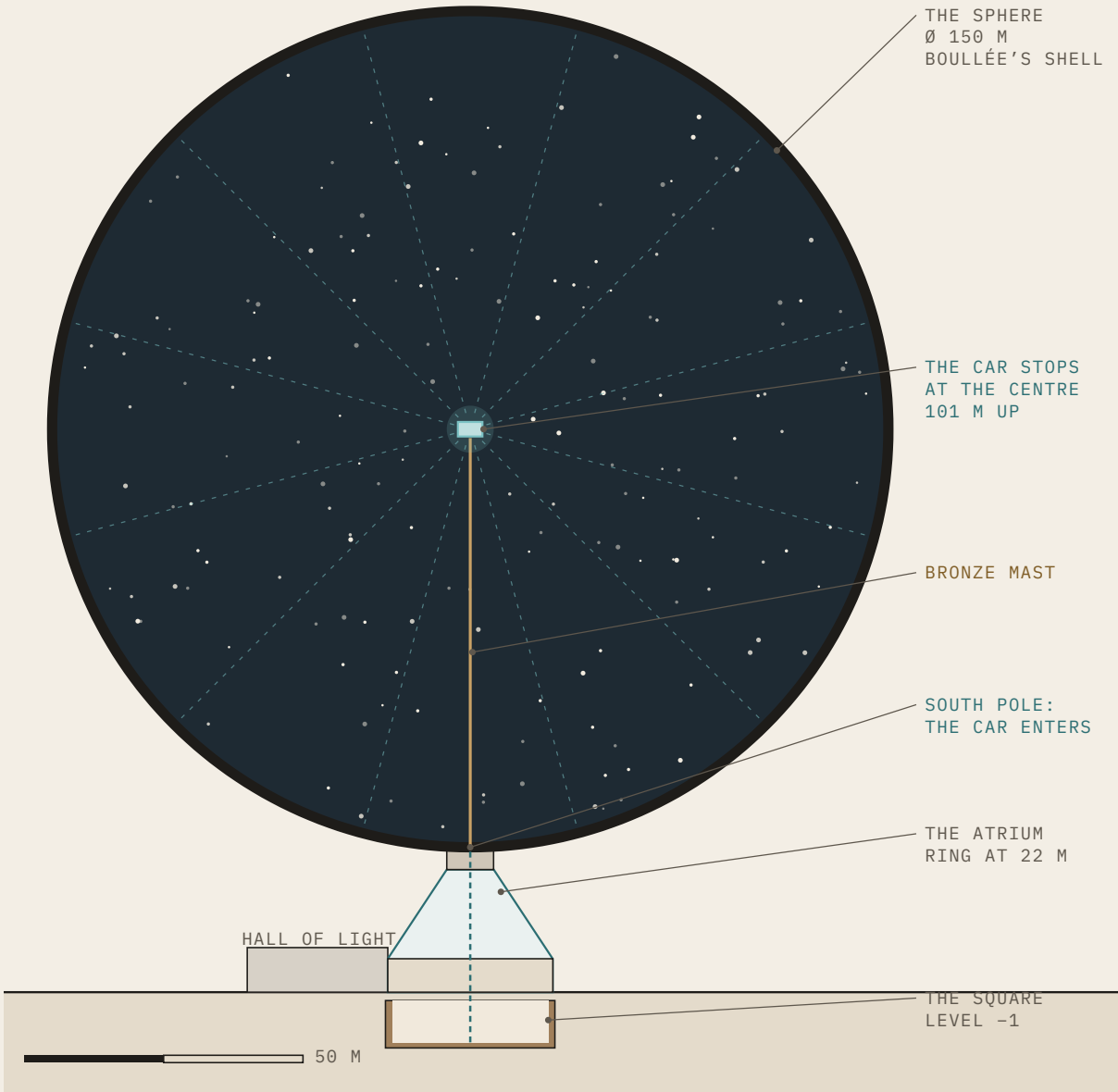
DAYLIGHT, DOWN THE SHAFT

GLASS FLOOR

SOIL, CLAY, CHALK, BEDROCK

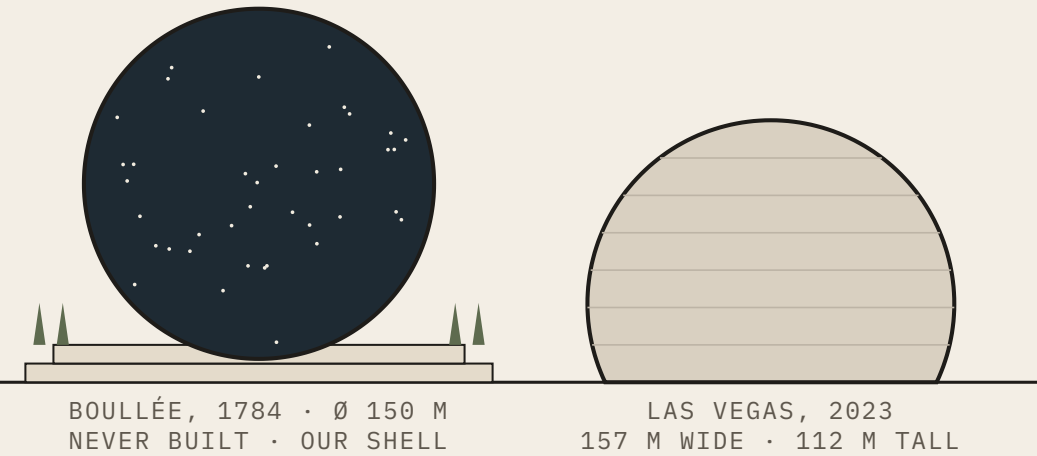
The Sphere

SECTION · TRUE SCALE · LOOKING NORTH
DASHED BLUE: EVERY LINE OF SIGHT MEETS THE SHELL SQUARE-ON



Boullée's 150-metre shell, used the way Las Vegas uses its Sphere: the whole inside is one image. The glass car stops at the exact centre, the only point where an image on a sphere looks true in every direction.

SAME SIZE, 239 YEARS APART



ALWAYS ON

The sky above you, now

The real sky over your location. By day, the stars the sun hides, as Boullée intended.

ON A TIMETABLE

New art on the whole shell

Works made for the full sphere, commissioned with the rest of Élan.

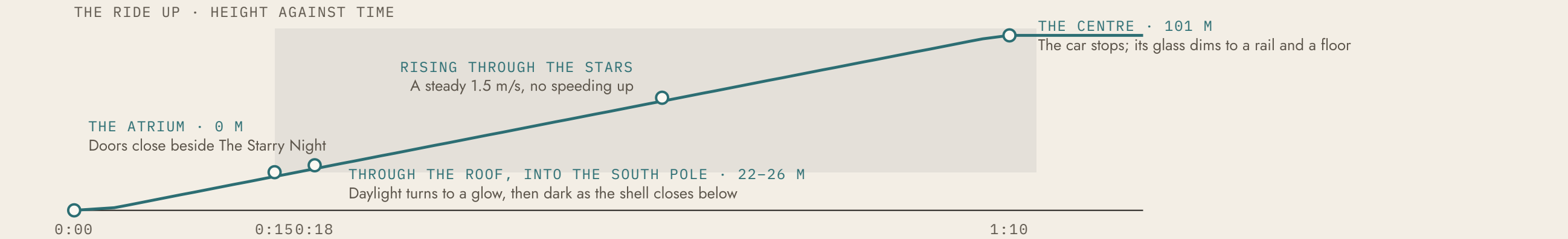
OPENING PIECE · PROPOSED

The sky becomes The Starry Night

The live sky slowly turns into Van Gogh's brushwork, keeping the promise of the painting beside the car.

Seventy seconds to the centre

Doors close beside The Starry Night. The car rises through the misty roof into the south pole, then through the stars at a steady 1.5 m/s, and stops 101 m up. Its glass dims to a rail and a floor.



WHERE YOU ARE

Las Vegas: 17,600 seats in tiers, facing forward

Élan: one glass car, at the exact centre

THE IMAGE

In front of you and overhead

All round you, below your feet too

FROM OUTSIDE

An LED skin, seen across the city

Never seen: the misty roof hides it

Kind to the eyes

Constant speed. The car's floor and a frosted rail stay in view the whole way.

A sky that holds still

The stars are drawn at infinity, so they do not slide past as you rise.

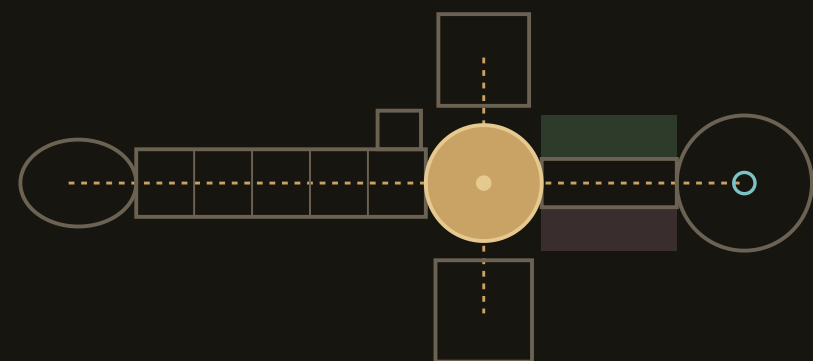
Down again

The same car, the same way. From the Square it is 9 m more.

DOWN AGAIN

Back to the sun

The same car, the same way down. Back west through the Hall of Light, the gardens either side, to the Rotunda, where every visit begins and the point of shadow has moved on by an hour or two.



STILL TO PLAN

The Atrium

Eleven bays A–K for new art; bay F on the axis for the headline piece

The Square

Four open galleries and four dark rooms

The Sphere

The timetable of works for the whole shell

The Chinese Wing

First design sheet, awaiting review